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Island

Robert Louis Stevenson

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Introduction

Once when his stepson was sick, Robert Louis Stevenson kept him company by making a map of an imaginary island. Thus was born the story of Treasure Island. The map they colored eventually appeared in the book's first pages. Besides the mysterious map, the story had cutthroat pirates, chests of buried treasure, a scheming one-legged cook, and a wild-eyed castaway. If kids don't like this story, Stevenson once said, "they have gone rotten."

Treasure Island is like a popular old type of adventure story called a romance. This kind of romance is not about love, but the brave feats of heroes, such as King Arthur's knights, who strive for noble goals. Stevenson made Treasure Island different by making the hero of the story a fatherless boy, Jim Hawkins. Jim is not really grown up enough to know what to do when certain things happen to him and he sometimes acts without thinking very far ahead.

Several characters in the story act like a father to Jim. One is among the most famous figures in literature, the charming and cunning Long John Silver. At times Long John protects and helps Jim, but sometimes they are rivals.

Treasure Island is also different from older adventure tales because it is not about meeting dangers in order to do good for others. It is about getting money. Treasure seems to put all the grown ups under a spell and they imagine how happy they can be if they get it. To Long John, the treasure promises a rich, powerful life. To have it would be a dream come true. So why, then, as Jim tells the story, does he say it was like a nightmare?

E.D.HirschJr.

Charlottesville, Virginia

Part I

Chapter 1 - The Old Sea Dog at the "admiral Benbow"

Squire Trelawney, Dr. Livesey, and the other gentlemen having asked me to write down the whole story about Treasure Island, keeping nothing back but the bearings, because there is still treasure there, I take up my pen in the year 17_____, and go back to the time when my father kept the "Admiral Benbow" inn, and the old seaman with the sabre cut across his cheek first lodged under our roof.

I remember him plodding to the inn door, bringing his sea chest behind him, a tall, strong, heavy, nut-brown man, his hands scarred, with black, broken nails. He looked round, whistled to himself, and then broke into that old sea song he sang so often afterwards: Then he rapped on the door with a stick, and when my father appeared, called roughly for a glass of rum. He drank it slowly, looking out at the cliffs and at our sign.

"This is a handy cove," says he.

"Much company, mate?" Father told him no, very little.

"Well, then," said he, "this is the berth for me. I'll stay here a bit. I'm a plain man," he continued, "rum and bacon and eggs is what I want, and a place to watch ships.

You can call me Captain." And he threw down four gold pieces.

"Tell me when I've worked through that," says he, looking fierce as a commander.

Indeed, bad as his clothes were, and as coarsely as he spoke, he seemed like a mate or skipper, accustomed to being obeyed.

He was a silent man. All day he hung round the cove with a brass telescope. All

evening he sat by the fire and drank rum. Mostly he would not speak when spoken to. He would just look up sudden and fierce. We soon learned to let him be. Every day he would ask if any seafaring men had gone by on the road.

At first we thought he wanted company of his own kind, but at last we began to see he wanted to avoid them. For me, there was no secret about this. He had taken me aside and promised me a silver penny on the first of every month if I would keep my “weather-eye open for a seafaring man with one leg,” and let him know the moment he appeared. Often when I asked him for my wage, he would stare me down. But later he would bring me my coin and repeat his orders.

How the man with one leg haunted my dreams. On stormy nights, when the wind shook the house, and the surf roared in the cove, I would see him in a thousand forms. Now the leg would be cut off at the knee, now at the hip. To see him leap and pursue me was the worst nightmare. I paid pretty dear for my monthly penny, in the shape of these terrible dreams. But I was far less afraid of the captain himself than anybody else who knew him. There were nights when he took more rum than his head would carry. Then he would sing his wild sea songs and force the trembling company to sing a chorus. Often I heard the house shaking with “Yoho-ho, and a bottle of rum,” all the neighbors joining in

with the fear of death upon them.

His stories frightened people worst of all. They were about hanging, and storms at sea, and wild deeds on the Spanish Main . He must have lived among some of the wickedest men ever on the sea. The language in which he told these stories shocked our plain country people almost as much as the crimes he described. He stayed month after month, so that the money had been long exhausted. If my father ever mentioned money, the captain roared and stared him out of the room. I am sure the terror my father lived in greatly hastened his death.

SPANISH

All the time he lived with us the cap- A name for the tain changed nothing in his dress but his along the coast of stockings. His coat, which he patched himself, by the end was nothing but patches.

He was only once crossed, when my poor father was very ill. Dr. Livesey came to see the patient, took a bit of dinner, and went into the parlor to smoke a pipe. I remember observing the contrast the neat doctor, with bright eyes and pleasant manners, made with that filthy scarecrow of a pirate, sitting far gone in rum. Suddenly the captain began his eternal song:

Yo-ho-ho, and a bottle of rum!

Drink and the devil had done for the rest –

Dr. Livesey looked up angrily before he went on talking to old Taylor, the gardener. The captain flapped his hand upon the table in a way we all knew to mean – silence. All voices stopped at once but Dr. Livesey’s. He went on speaking clear and kind, drawing at his pipe between every word or two. The captain glared at him, flapped his hand again, and yelled: “Silence there, between decks!”

“Were you addressing me, sir?” says the doctor.

“I have only one thing to say to you. If you keep on drinking rum, the world will soon be quit of a very dirty scoundrel!”

“if you don’t put that knife this instant in your pocket, i promise, on my honor, you shall hang.”

The old fellow’s fury was awful. He sprang to his feet, drew a knife, and threatened to pin the doctor to the wall.

The doctor never moved. He spoke so that everyone might hear: “If you don’t put that knife this instant in your pocket, I promise, on my honor, you shall hang.” Then followed a battle of looks between them. Soon the captain put up his weapon and sat down, grumbling like a beaten dog.

“I’ll have an eye on you day and night,” said the doctor.

“I’m a magistrate – if I catch a breath of complaint against you, I’ll have you hunted down.”

Soon after, Dr. Livesey rode away, but the captain held his peace that evening, and for many evenings to come.

Chapter 2 - Black Dog Appears and Disappears

Not long after this came the first of the mysterious events that rid us at last of the captain, though not of his affairs. It was a bitter cold winter, and it was plain that my poor father was unlikely to. One January morning very early, the captain the skirts of the old blue coat, his brass telescope under his arm, his hat tilted back.

Mother was upstairs with father, and I was setting the breakfast table when the parlor door opened, and a man stepped in on whom I had never set eyes before. He was a pale creature, missing two fingers of his left hand. He was not like a sailor, yet he had a smack of the sea about him.

“Is this here table for my mate Bill?” he asked, with a kind of leer.

I told him that this was for someone called the captain who stayed in our house.

“Well,” said he, “my mate Bill would likely be called the captain. Let’s say that your captain has a cut on one cheek – the right one. Now, is my mate Bill in this here house?”

I told him he was out walking.

“Which way is he gone?”

When I had told him how the captain was likely to return, and how soon, he said, “Ah, this’ll be as good as drink to my mate Bill.”

I had my own reasons for thinking the stranger was mistaken. But it was no affair of mine, I thought. Besides, it was difficult to know what to do. The stranger stood inside the door, peering round it like a cat waiting for a mouse. Once I stepped out myself, but he ordered me in with an oath that made me jump. Then he patted me on the shoulder, told me I was a good boy, and that he had taken quite a fancy to me.

“But the great thing for boys is discipline, sonny. If you had sailed with Bill, you wouldn’t have stood there to be spoke to twice. We’ll just go back behind the door, and give Bill a little surprise.”

The stranger put me behind him in the corner, so that we were both hidden by the door. I was very uneasy, and it added to my fears that the stranger was frightened himself. He cleared the hilt of his cutlass and loosened the blade in the sheath. And all the time we were waiting there he kept swallowing as if he had a lump in the throat.

At last the captain strode in, slammed the door, and marched straight to his breakfast.

“Bill,” said the stranger, in a voice he tried to make bold.

The captain spun around on his heel. He had the look of a man who sees a ghost, or something worse, if anything can be. Upon my word, I felt sorry to see him, all in a moment, turn so old and sick.

“Black Dog!” he gasped.

“And who else?” returned the other, getting more at ease.

“Black Dog come to see his old shipmate Billy. Ah,

Bill, Bill, we have seen a sight of times, us two, since I lost them two talons,” holding up his mutilated hand.

“Now look here,” said the captain.

“You’ve run me down. Speak up: what is it?”

“I’ll have a glass of rum, and we’ll sit down, and talk square, like old mates,” said Black Dog.

When I returned, they were seated—Black Dog next to the door, sitting sideways, to have one eye on his old shipmate, and one on his retreat.

For a long time, I could hear nothing but low gabbling. At last the voices grew higher, and I could pick up a word or two, mostly oaths, from the captain.

“No, an end of it!” he cried once, and, “If it comes to hanging, hang all, say I.” Then there was an explosion of oaths and noises – the chair and table went over, a clash of steel followed, and then a cry of pain. The next instant I saw

Black Dog in full flight, and the captain hotly pursuing, both with drawn cutlasses. Blood streamed from Black Dog’s left shoulder. At the door, the captain aimed one thenextins ta nti saw b l ac kdoginfullfligh t. last tremendous cut, which would certainly have split Black Dog to the backbone had it not been intercepted by the inn’s signboard.

Once on the road, Black Dog, in spite of his wound, disappeared over the hill in half a minute. The captain stood staring like a bewildered man. At last he turned back into the house.

“Jim,” says he, “rum.” And he reeled and caught himself with one hand against the wall.

“I must get away from here. Rum! Rum!”

I ran to fetch it, but while I was fumbling, I heard a loud fall in the parlor, and running in, saw the captain lying on the floor. My mother, alarmed by cries and fighting, came running downstairs. Between us, we raised his head. He was breathing very loud and hard. His eyes were closed, and his face a horrible color.

We had no idea what to do to help him, when Dr. Livesey came in to visit my father.

“Oh, doctor,” we cried, “what shall we do? Where is he wounded?”

“Wounded? No, the man has had a stroke, as I warned him. Now, Mrs. Hawkins, run upstairs to your husband, and tell him nothing about it. I must do my best to save this fellow’s worthless life. Jim, you get me a basin.”

When I got back with the basin, the doctor had already exposed the captain’s great sinewy arm. It was tattooed in several places.

“Here’s luck,” “A fair wind,” and “Billy Bones his fancy” were on the forearm. Up near the shoulder there was a sketch of a gallows and a man hanging from it – done with great spirit.

“Prophetic,” said the doctor, touching this picture with his finger.

“Jim,” he said, “are you afraid of blood?”

“No, sir,” said I.

“You hold the basin then,” said he, and with that he took a lancet and opened a vein.

A great deal of blood was taken before the captain opened his eyes and looked mistily about him. First he recognized the doctor with an unmistakable frown. Then he saw me, and he looked relieved. But suddenly his color changed, and he tried to raise himself, crying, “Where’s Black Dog?”

“There’s no Black Dog here,” said the doctor.

“You have been drinking and you have had a stroke. I have just dragged you out of the grave.

“Hear this: one glass of rum won’t kill you, but if you take one you’ll take another and another, and if you don’t stop, you’ll die – do you understand? Come now, I’ll help you to bed.”

We managed to hoist him upstairs and laid him on his bed. Then the doctor went off to see my father, taking me by the arm.

“I have drawn blood enough to keep him quiet awhile,” he said.

“He should lie for a week where he is. Another stroke would finish him.”

Chapter 3 - The Black Spot

About noon I brought the captain some cooling drinks and medicines. He was lying very much as “Jim,” he said, “you know I’ve been good to you.

I’m pretty low, and deserted by all. You’ll bring me one

"The doctor – " I began. SWABS

Useless But he broke in, cursing the doctor. persons.

"Doctors is all swabs ," he said.

"What does he know about seafaring men? I been in places hot as pitch, and mates dropping with Yellow Jack and the land heaving like the sea with earthquakes – what do the doctor know of lands like that? I've lived on rum. It's been meat JACK and drink to me. If I'm not to have my rum now, Yellow my blood'll be on you, Jim, and that doctor fever. swab. Look how my fingers tremble," he pleaded.

"I can't keep 'em still. If I don't have rum, I'll have the horrors. If I get the horrors, I'll raise Cain. Your doctor himself said one glass wouldn't hurt me."

He was growing more excited, and this alarmed me for my father, who needed quiet. Besides, I was assured by the doctor's words, now quoted to me.

"I'll get you one glass, and no more." When I brought it, he seized it greedily, and drank it out.

"Ay, ay," said he, "that's better, sure enough. Did that doctor say how long I was to lie here?"

"A week at least," said I.

"Thunder!" he cried.

"A week! I can't do that –

they'd have the black spot on me by then. The lubbers couldn't keep what they got, and want mine." As he was speaking, he rose with great difficulty, holding my shoulder with a grip that almost made me cry out.

"That doctor's done me," he murmured.

"My ears is singing." And he fell back on the bed.

"Jim," he said, at length, "you saw Black Dog? He's a bad 'un, but there's worse that put him on. Now, if I can't get away and they tip me the black spot, it's my old sea chest they're after. You get on a horse and go to that doctor and tell him to pipe all hands – magistrates and such – to the 'Admiral Benbow' – all Flint's crew that's left. I was Flint's first mate, and I'm the only one knows the place. He gave it to me at Savannah, when he lay dying, like as if I was to now. But you won't tell unless they get the black spot on me, or you see Black

Dog again, or a seafaring man with one leg, Jim – him above all."

"But what is the black spot, captain?" I asked.

"That's a summons, mate. Keep your weather-eye open, Jim, and I'll share with you equals, upon my honor."

His voice grew weaker, and soon he fell into a heavy sleep. Probably I should have

told the whole story to the doctor, but my poor father died quite suddenly that evening, which put aside all other matters. Our distress, the visits of the neighbors, the arranging of the funeral, and all the work of the inn kept me so busy that I had scarcely time to think of the captain.

He got downstairs next morning and had his meals, though he ate little, and had more than his usual supply of rum. He helped himself, and no one dared to cross him. On the night before the funeral he was drunk, and it was shocking in that house of mourning to hear him singing away at his ugly old sea song. But, weak as he was, we were all in the fear of death for him.

He clambered up and down stairs, holding on to the walls, and breathing hard like a man on a steep mountain. His temper was worse than ever. When he was drunk he drew his cutlass and lay it on the table.

The day after the funeral, I was standing at the door full of sad thoughts about my father, when I saw a blind man coming slowly along the road. He tapped before him with a stick, and wore a green shade over his eyes and nose. He was hunched, as if from age or weakness, and wore a tattered sea cloak with a hood that made him appear deformed. Raising his voice in an odd sing-song, he addressed the air in front of him: "Will anyone inform a poor blind man who has lost his sight in the defense of England – God bless King the captain made a movement to rise, but i do not believe he George! – where he may now be?"

"You are at the 'Admiral Benbow,' Black Hill Cove," said I.

"I hear a young voice," said he.

"Will you give me your hand and lead me in?"

I held out my hand, and the horrible creature gripped it like a vise. I struggled to withdraw, but the blind man pulled me close to him.

"Now, boy," he said, "take me to the captain."

"Sir, upon my word I dare not."

"Take me in straight, or I'll break your arm." And he gave it a wrench that made me cry out.

"Sir, the captain sits with a drawn cutlass – "

"March," he interrupted, and I never heard a voice so cruel and cold as that blind man's. I obeyed him at once, walking towards where our sick buccaneer was sitting, dazed with rum. The blind man clung to me, holding me in one iron fist.

"Lead me straight to him, and when I'm in view, cry out, 'Here's a friend for you, Bill.'" As I opened the parlor door, I cried out the words in a trembling voice.

The captain made a movement to rise, but I do not believe he had enough force left in his body. Then I saw the blind man pass something into the captain's palm, which closed upon it instantly.

"Now that's done," said the blind man. And with incredible accuracy and nimbleness,

he skipped out of the parlor and into the road, where I could hear his stick tapping in the distance.

When we gathered our senses, the captain drew in his hand and looked into the palm.

“Ten o’clock!” he cried.

“Six hours. We’ll do them yet.” And he sprang to his feet. Even as he did so, he reeled, put his hand to his throat, stood swaying for a moment, and then fell.

I ran to him at once, but haste was in vain. The captain was dead. As soon as I saw that he was dead, I burst into tears. It was the second death I had known, and the sorrow of the first was still fresh in my heart.

Chapter 4 - The Sea Chest

I lost no time telling my mother all that I knew, and we saw ourselves in a dangerous position. Some of the man’s money was due to us, but it was not likely that his shipmates would pay the dead man’s debts. The captain’s order to ride for Dr. Livesey would have left my mother alone and unprotected, which was not to be thought of. Indeed, it seemed impossible for us to remain much longer in the house. The neighborhood seemed haunted by approaching footsteps. We decided to seek help in the neighboring hamlet and ran out at once in the frosty fog.

The hamlet lay not far away and in an opposite direction from that whence the blind man had come and where he had presumably returned. On the road we sometimes stopped to hold onto each other and listen, but there was nothing but the wash of ripples.

It was dark when we reached the hamlet, and no soul would return with us to the inn. The name of Captain Flint carried a great weight of terror. Some of the men saw several strangers on the road, and taking them to be smugglers, had bolted away. One at least had seen a lugger in Kitt’s Hole. While several were willing enough to ride to Dr. LUGGER Livesey’s, not one would help defend the inn.

They say cowardice is infectious, but argument can make you bold. So when each had said his say, my mother made a speech. She would not, she declared, lose money that belonged to her fatherless boy.

“Back we will go, and small thanks to you chicken-hearted men.”

They all cried out at our foolhardiness. All they would do was give me a loaded pistol, in case we were attacked, and to promise to have horses saddled, in case we were pursued on our return. One lad rode to the doctor’s for help.

A full moon was rising and this increased our haste, for soon it would be as bright as day. We slipped along the hedges, noiseless and swift, and at last closed the door of the “Admiral Benbow” behind us.

I slipped the bolt, and we stood in the dark, alone in the house with the captain’s body. My mother got a candle, and holding hands, we went into the parlor. He lay on his back, with his eyes open, and one arm stretched out.

"Draw the blind, Jim," whispered my mother.

"We have to get the key off that." And she sobbed as she said the words.

I went down on my knees at once. Close to his hand was a round of paper, black on one side. Taking it up, I found written on the other side, in a clear hand, "You have till ten tonight."

Just then, our old clock struck six.

I felt in his pockets. A few coins, a thimble, thread and needles, tobacco, a knife, a compass, and a tinder box were all they held.

"Perhaps it's round his neck," suggested my mother.

Overcoming a strong repugnance, I tore open his shirt, and there, sure enough, hanging to a bit of tarry string, which I cut with his knife, we found the key. We were filled with hope, and hurried upstairs to his room.

His box had the initial "B" burned on the top of it, and the corners were smashed and broken by long, rough use.

My mother threw back the lid in a twinkling.

A strong smell of tobacco and tar rose from the interior. On the top was a suit of clothes, never worn. Under that were a quadrant, a tin, tobacco, pistols, a bar of silver, a Spanish watch, compasses, and some West Indian shells.

Underneath was an old cloak, whitened with sea salt. My mother pulled it up, and at the bottom lay a bundle tied up in oilcloth and a canvas bag that gave forth the jingle of gold.

"I'm an honest woman," said my mother.

"I'll have my dues, and not a farthing over." And she began to count the money into a bag. and she began to count the money into a bag.

It was difficult, for the coins were of all countries and sizes – doubloons, and louis-d'ors, and guineas, and pieces of eight. The guineas were the scarcest, and it was with these only that my mother knew how to make her count.

Suddenly I heard the tap-tapping of the blind man's stick upon the frozen road. It drew nearer, while we held our breath. Then it struck the inn door, and we could hear the bolt rattling as he tried to enter. There was a long silence. At last the tapping began again, and, to our joy, died slowly away until it ceased to be heard.

"Mother," said I, "take it all." I was sure the bolt-

ed door seemed suspicious, and would bring the whole hornet's nest about our ears.

My mother, frightened as she was, would not take a fraction more or less than was due her. She was arguing with me when a low whistle sounded on the hill. That was enough.

"I'll take what I have," she said, jumping to her feet.

"And I'll take this to square the count," said I, picking up the oilskin packet.

We groped downstairs, leaving the candle by the chest. In a moment we had opened

the door and were in full retreat. The fog was dispersing and the moon shone clear. We could hear the sound of running footsteps and, looking back, saw a light rapidly advancing.

“My dear,” said my mother suddenly, “run on with the money. I am going to faint.”

This was the end for us, I thought. How I cursed the neighbors’ cowardice, and how I blamed my poor mother for her foolhardiness and present weakness! We crossed the little bridge and I helped her to the bank, where she gave a sigh and fell on my shoulder. I managed to drag her down a little way under the arch. There we stayed, within earshot of the inn.

Chapter 5 - The Last of the Blind Man

My curiosity was stronger than my fear. I crept back to the bank, where I could see eight of my enemies arrived, running hard. Three men ran together, hand in hand. I made out through the mist that They made a rush upon the inn, then paused, as if they were surprised to find the door open.

“In, in, in!” the blind man shouted, and he cursed them for their delay.

Four or five men obeyed at once, and two remained on the road. There was a cry of surprise, and a shout from the house: “Bill’s dead.”

“Search him, you shirking lubbers, and the rest of you get the chest,” the blind man cried.

I could hear their feet rattling up our stairs. The window of the captain’s room was thrown open with a slam and a jingle of broken glass. A man leaned out into the moonlight and addressed the blind beggar below.

“Pew,” he cried, “Someone’s already been through the chest.”

“Is it there?” roared Pew.

“The money’s there.”

The blind man cursed the money.

“Flint’s fist, I mean,” he cried.

“We don’t see it here nohow.”

“You below there, is it on Bill?” cried the blind man again.

A voice answered, “Bill’s been searched already,” said he.

“Nothing left.”

“It’s that boy. I wish I had put his eyes out!” cried the blind man.

“They were here no time ago. Scatter, lads, and find ‘em. Clear the house out!” ordered Pew, striking his stick on the road.

There was a great to-do through all our old inn. Furniture was thrown over, doors kicked in. The men came out again and declared that we were nowhere to be found. Just then a whistle was clearly audible through the night, this time twice repeated. It was a signal from

the hillside, and, from its effect on the buccaneers, a signal to warn them of approaching danger.

“There’s Dirk again,” said one.

“Twice! We’ll have to budge, mates.”

“They can’t be far,” cried Pew.

“Scatter and look for them, dogs! Oh, if I had eyes!”

Two men began to look, but with half an eye to danger all the time, while the rest stood in the road, uncertain what to do.

“You have your hands on thousands, you fools, and you hang a leg! You’d be as rich as kings if you could find it, and you stand there skulking. No one dared face Bill but me – a blind man! And I’m to lose my chance for you! If you had the pluck of a weevil in a biscuit you would catch them still.”

“Hang it, Pew, we’ve got the doubloons!” grumbled one.

“They might have hid the blessed thing,” said another.

“Take the coins, Pew, and don’t stand there squalling.”

Pew’s anger rose so high that he struck at them right and left in his blindness.

They, in turn, cursed the blind man, threatened him in horrid terms, and tried in vain to catch his stick and take it from him.

This quarrel saved us. For while it was raging, another sound came from the top of the hill – galloping horses. A pistol shot came from the hedge, and that was plainly the last signal of danger. The buccaneers ran in every direction, one seaward along the cove, one slant across the hill, and so on, so that in half a minute only Pew remained. They had deserted him. But he tapped up and down the road in a frenzy, calling for his comrades.

Finally he took a wrong turn, and ran a few steps past me, crying: “Johnny, Black Dog, Dirk, don’t leave old Pew, mates!”

Just then four or five riders swept at full gallop down the slope. Pew’s anger rose so high that he struck at them

Pew sensed his error, turned with a scream, and rolled into the ditch. He was on his feet again in a second, and made another dash, utterly bewildered, right under one of the horses. The rider tried to save him, but in vain. Down went Pew with a cry that rang high into the night.

I leaped to my feet and hailed the riders. They were horrified at the accident. One was the lad that had gone to Dr. Livesey’s. The rest were revenue officers whom he had met by the way. News of the lugger in Kitt’s Hole had found its way to Supervisor Dance and started him in our direction. To that chance, we owed our lives.

Pew was dead. We carried my mother up to the hamlet, and a little cold water and salts brought her back again. In the meantime the supervisor rode on to Kitt’s Hole. By the

time he got there the lugger was underway, though still close in. He hailed her. A voice replied, telling him to keep out of the moonlight, or he would get some lead in him. At the same time a bullet whistled by. Soon after, the lugger disappeared.

I went back with him to the “Admiral Benbow,” and you cannot imagine a house in such a state of smash. I could see at once that we were ruined.

“They got the money, you say?” said Mr. Dance.

“Well, Hawkins, what were they after?”

“I believe I have the thing in my pocket,” I replied.

“I should like to get it to Dr. Livesey.”

“I will ride there myself and report to him,” said

Mr. Dance.

“Pew’s dead. Not that I regret it, but people will make it out against an officer of his Majesty. If you like, Hawkins, I’ll take you.”

We walked back to the hamlet, where the horses were, and I told mother of my purpose.

Soon we struck out at a bouncing trot on the road to Dr. Livesey’s house.

Chapter 6 - The Captain’s Papers

We rode hard till we drew up before Dr.

Livesey’s door. His maid told us that he had gone to the Hall to pass the evening with the When we arrived there, the servant showed us into the library where the squire and Dr. Livesey sat on either The squire was a tall man and he had a rough-and-ready face. His eyebrows moved readily, and this gave him “Come in, Mr. Dance,” says he, very stately.

“Good evening, Dance,” says the doctor, with a nod.

“And good evening to you, Jim. What wind brings you here?”

The supervisor stood straight and stiff and told his story. The two gentlemen leaned forward and forgot to smoke their pipes in their interest. When they heard how my mother went back to the inn, Dr. Livesey slapped his thigh, and the squire cried, “Bravo!”

“Mr. Dance,” said the squire, when the story was finished, “you are a noble fellow.”

“And so, Jim,” said the doctor, “you have what they were after, have you?”

“Here it is, sir,” said I.

“Squire,” he said, “Dance must be off on his Maj-

esty’s service, but I mean to keep Jim Hawkins here to sleep at my house. With your permission, I propose we should let him eat.”

A big pigeon pie was brought in and I made a hearty supper, while Mr. Dance was further complimented and dismissed.

“Now, squire,” said the doctor, “you have heard of this Flint, I suppose?”

“Heard of him!” cried the squire.

“He was the bloodthirstiest buccaneer that sailed. Blackbeard was a child to Flint.”

“Supposing I have here in my pocket some clue to where Flint buried his treasure, will that treasure amount to much?” asked the doctor.

“If we have the clue you talk about,” said the squire, “I will fit out a ship in Bristol, and take you and Hawkins along, and have that treasure if I search a year.”

The doctor laid the bundle before him on the table. It was sewn together, and the doctor had to cut the stitches with his medical scissors. It contained two things – a book and a sealed paper.

The squire and I peered over the doctor’s shoulder as he opened the book. On the first page there were scraps of writing, one the same as the tattoo, “Billy Bones his fancy.” Most words were unintelligible.

The next ten or twelve pages were filled with a curious series of entries. There was a date at one end of the line and at the other a sum of money, with a varying number of crosses between the two. On the 12th of June, 1745, for instance, a sum of seventy pounds had become due to someone, and there was nothing but six crosses to explain the cause. In a few cases, the name of a place would be added, as “Off Caracas,” or an entry of latitude and longitude.

The record lasted over nearly twenty years, the amount of the separate entries growing larger as time went on, and at the end a grand total had been made out and these words appended: “Bones, his pile.”

“This is his account book,” cried the squire.

“These crosses stand for the ships or towns they sank or plundered. The sums are the scoundrel’s share. As the amounts increase, he rose in rank. And now, the other.”

The doctor opened the paper with great care, and there fell out the map of an island, with latitude and longitude, soundings, names of hills, bays, and inlets, and every particular needed to bring a ship to a safe anchorage upon its shores. It was about nine miles long and five across, shaped like a fat dragon standing up, had two fine landlocked harbors, and a hill in the center marked the Spyglass. There were several additions of a later date, but above all, three crosses of red ink – two on the north part of the island, one in the southwest, and, beside this last, in the same red ink, and in a small, neat hand, very different from the captain’s tottery char-
THE DOCTOR OPENED THE PAPER WITH GREAT CARE , AND
THERE FELL
On the back, in the same hand: Tall tree, Spyglass shoulder, bearing a point to the N. of N.N.E. Skeleton Island E.S.E. and by E. Ten feet. The bar silver is in the north cache. Find it by the trend of the east hummock, ten fathoms south of the crag with the face on it. The arms are in the sandhill, N. point of north inlet cape, bearing E. and a quarter N. —‘J.F.’

Brief as it was, and to me, incomprehensible, it “Tomorrow I start for Bristol,” said the squire.

"In ten days we'll have the best ship and crew in England. Hawkins shall come as cabin boy. You, Livesey, are ship's

Hunter. We'll have no difficulty in finding the spot, and "I'll go with you," said the doctor.

"So will Jim.

"Name the dog, sir!" cried the squire.

"You," replied the doctor, "for you cannot hold your tongue. Others know of this paper. These fellows who attacked the inn tonight, and the rest who stayed aboard the lugger, are bound that they'll get that money. None of us should go alone. Jim and I shall stick together. You take

Joyce and Hunter to Bristol, and not one of us must breathe a word of what we've found."

"I'll be as silent as the grave," said the squire.

Part II

Chapter 7 - I Go to Bristol

It was longer than the squire imagined before we were ready for the sea. The doctor had to go to London for a physician to take charge of his practice. The squire was hard at work at Bristol, and I lived at the Hall under the charge of old Redruth, the gamekeeper, full of sea

I brooded over the map, all the details of which I well remembered. I approached that island in my fancy from every direction, and explored every acre of its surwas thick with savages, sometimes full of dangerous animals. But nothing occurred to me so strange and tragic So the weeks passed, till a letter came for Dr. Livesey, with a note to open it in his absence:

Old Anchor Inn, Bristol, March 1, 17__

Dear Livesey, The ship lies at anchor, ready for sea. You never imagined a sweeter schooner. A child might sail her. Her name is Hispaniola . I got her through my old friend Blandly. The fellow literally slaved in my interest, and so did every one in Bristol, as soon as they got wind of the port we sailed for – treasure, I mean.

At first, finding a crew troubled me. I wanted twenty men, and I had difficulty finding half a dozen, till fortune brought me the man I required.

I fell into talk with him on the dock. He keeps a public house and I found he knew all the seafaring men in Bristol. He lost his health ashore, and wanted a good berth as cook to get to sea again. He had hobbled down there that morning, he said, to get a smell of the salt. I was monstously touched, and engaged him on the spot to be ship's cook. Long John Silver he is called, and has lost a leg in his country's service.

Between Silver and myself we got together a company of the toughest old salts imaginable – I declare we could fight a frigate. Long John even got rid of two men I had

already engaged, showing me that they were just the sort of freshwater swabs we had to fear in an adventure of importance.

I am in magnificent health and spirits, eating like a bull, sleeping like a tree, yet I shall not enjoy a moment till we are under way.

So now, Livesey, come quickly.

P.S. Blandly is to send another ship after us if we don't turn up by the end of August. He found an admirable fellow for captain – a stiff man, but, in all other respects, a treasure. Long John Silver unearthed a very competent mate. Silver is a man of substance – he has a bank account, which has never been overdrawn. He leaves his wife – a woman of color – to manage the inn. —J.T.

You can fancy the excitement the letter brought me. I was beside myself with glee.

The next morning Redruth and I set out on foot for the “Admiral Benbow.” There I found my mother in good health and spirits. The squire had had everything repaired, and added a beautiful armchair for mother. He found her an apprentice to help while I was gone.

On seeing that boy I understood, for the first time, my situation. I had thought up to that moment of the adventures before me, not at all of the home that I was leaving. And now, at the sight of this clumsy stranger who was to stay here in my place, I had my first attack of tears.

The next day, after dinner, I said goodbye to mother and the cove where I had lived since I was born, and the dear old “Admiral Benbow.” The mail coach picked us up about dusk at the “Royal George” on the heath, and we arrived in Bristol after daybreak.

Mr. Trelawney had stayed at an inn along the docks to superintend the work on the schooner. Along the quays lay ships of all sizes and rigs and nations. In one, sailors were singing at their work. In another, men aloft were hanging to threads that seemed no thicker than a spider's. the next day, after dinner, i said goodbye to mother and the cove where i had lived since i was born.

Though I had lived by the shore all my life, I seemed never to have been near the sea till then. The smell of tar and salt was something new. I saw the most wonderful figureheads, and old sailors with rings in their ears, and tarry pigtails, and their swaggering, clumsy sea walk. If I had seen as many kings, I could not have been more delighted.

While I was still in this delightful dream, we met Squire Trelawney, dressed like a sea officer, in stout blue cloth, with an excellent imitation of a sailor's walk.

“Here you are,” he cried, “and the doctor came last night from London. Bravo! The ship's company is complete! We sail tomorrow!”

Chapter 8 - At the Sign of the “spyglass”

When I had finished breakfast, the squire gave me a note addressed to John Silver at should easily find the place by following the line of the docks, keeping a lookout for a little tavern with a large brass telescope for a sign. I picked my way among a crowd of people and carts and bales along the dock until I found

It was a bright little place. The sign was newly painted, the windows had neat red curtains, the floor was cleanly sanded. The customers were mostly seafaring men, and they talked so loudly that I was almost afraid to enter. As I was waiting, a man came out of a side room, and, at a glance, I was sure he must be Long John. His left leg was cut off close by the hip, and under the left shoulder he carried a crutch, which he managed with wonderful dexterity, hopping about on it like a bird. He was very tall and strong, with a face as big as a ham – but intelligent and smiling. Indeed, he seemed in the most cheerful spirits. He whistled as he moved among the tables, and had a merry word or a slap on the shoulder for his favored guests.

From the first mention of Long John in Squire Trelawney's letter, I had feared that he might be the very one-legged sailor whom I had watched for at the old "Benbow." But one look at the man was enough. I had seen the captain, and Black Dog, and the blind man Pew. I thought I knew what a buccaneer was like – very different from this clean and pleasant-tempered landlord.

I plucked up courage and walked up to him.

"Mr.

Silver, sir?" I asked, holding out the note.

"Yes, lad," said he.

"And who may you be?" As he saw the squire's letter, he seemed startled.

"Oh!" he said quite loud.

"Our new cabin boy."

Just then one of the customers rose suddenly and made for the door. He was out in the street in a moment, but I recognized him at a glance. It was the man missing two fingers who had come first to the "Admiral Benbow."

"Stop him!" I cried.

"It's Black Dog!"

"I don't care two coppers who he is," cried Silver.

"But he hasn't paid his bill. Catch him."

One of the others nearest the door leapt up and started in pursuit.

"Who did you say he was?" he asked.

"Black what?"

"Dog, sir," I said.

"Has Mr. Trelawney not told you of the buccaneers? He was one."

"So?" cried Silver.

"Let's see – Black Dog? I don't

know the name, yet I think I've seen the swab. He used to come here with a blind beggar."

“That was Pew,” I said.

“It was!” cried Silver, quite excited.

“Pew! That “stop him!” i cried.

“it’s black dog!” were his name. If we run down this Black Dog, there’ll be news for Cap’n Trelawney!”

All the time he was talking he was giving such a show of excitement as would have convinced a judge. My suspicions had been thoroughly reawakened on finding Black Dog at the “Spyglass,” and I watched the cook narrowly. But he was too clever for me, and by the time the men had come back out of breath, and confessed that they had lost the track in a crowd, and been scolded like thieves, I would have gone bail for the innocence of Long John Silver.

“See here, Hawkins,” said he, “What’s Cap’n

Trelawney to think? Here I have this scoundrel sitting in my own house, drinking my rum! Here I let him give us all the slip before my blessed deadlights ! Now, Hawkins, do me justice with the captain. You’re a lad, but you’re DEADLIGHTS as smart as paint. I see that when you first came Eyes. in. What could I do, with this old timber I hobble on? I’ll go with you to Cap’n Trelawney and report this here affair.”

Along the quays, he made himself the most interesting companion, telling me about the ships that we passed by, explaining the work that was going on, and every now and then telling me some little anecdote of ships or seamen, or repeating a nautical phrase till I had learned it perfectly. I began to see that he was one of the best of possible shipmates.

When we got to the inn, the squire and Dr. Livesey were finishing a quart of ale, before making an inspection of the schooner. Long John told the story with a great deal of spirit.

“That was how it were, now, weren’t it, Hawkins?” he would say, and I could always bear him out.

The two gentlemen regretted Black Dog’s escape, but we all agreed there was nothing to be done, and after he had been complimented, Long John took up his crutch and departed.

“All hands aboard by four this afternoon,” shout-

ed the squire after him.

“Ay, ay, sir,” cried the cook, in the passage.

“Well, squire,” said Dr. Livesey, “I don’t put much faith in your discoveries, as a rule, but John Silver suits me.”

Chapter 9 - Powder and Arms

As we stepped aboard the Hispaniola , we were saluted by the mate, Mr. Arrow, an old sailor with earrings in his ears and a squint. He and the squire were very friendly, but things were not the This last was a sharp-looking man, who seemed angry with everything on board, and

was soon to tell us why, for we had hardly got down into the cabin when a “Captain Smollett, sir, asking to speak with you,” said he.

“Show him in,” said the squire. The captain entered, and shut the door.

“Well, Captain, what have you to say? All’s well, I hope?”

“Well, sir,” said the captain, “I don’t like this cruise. I don’t like the men, and I don’t like my officer. That’s short and sweet.”

“Possibly, sir, you may not like your employer, either?” said the squire. But here Dr. Livesey cut in.

“Hold on,” said he, “Captain, you don’t like this cruise. Why?”

“I was engaged, sir, on what we call sealed orders, to sail this ship where that gentleman should bid me,” said the captain.

“Now I find that every man before the mast knows more than I do. Next, I learn from my hands that we are going after treasure. I don’t like treasure voyages, BEFORE THE mast above all when they are secret, and the Common sailors secret has been told to the parrot.” the mast and officers “Silver’s parrot?” asked the squire.

“It’s a way of speaking. Blabbed, I mean,” said the captain.

“It’s my belief neither of you gentlemen know what you are getting into. I think it’ll be life or death, and a close run.”

“We take the risk,” said Dr. Livesey, “but we are not so ignorant as you believe us. Next, you say you don’t like the crew?”

“I think I should have had the choosing of my own hands, sir,” returned the captain.

“My friend should, perhaps, have taken you along,” said the Doctor.

“But the slight was unintentional. And you don’t like Mr. Arrow?”

“I don’t, sir. He’s a good seaman, but he’s too famil-

iar with the crew to be a good officer. A mate should keep to himself. Hear me a few words more. They are putting the powder and arms in the forehold. Why not put them under the cabin? Why not give your own people the berths beside the cabin?”

“Any more?” asked Mr. Trelawney.

“Yes. I’ve heard that you have a map of the island where crosses show where treasure is, and that the island lies ____.” And then he named the latitude and longitude exactly.

“I never told that to a soul!” cried the squire.

“It doesn’t much matter who it was,” replied the doctor. In this case I believe Mr. Trelawney was really right, and that nobody had told the location of the island.

“Gentlemen,” continued the captain, “I don’t know who has this map, but it shall be kept secret even from me and Mr. Arrow. Otherwise I would ask you to let me resign.”

"I see," said the doctor.

"You fear a mutiny."

"Sir," said Captain Smollett, "No captain would be justified in going to sea at all if he had enough evidence to say that. Mr. Arrow I believe to be thoroughly honest, and all may be for what I know. But I am responsible for the ship's safety and the life of every man aboard her. I see things going not right. I ask you to take certain precautions, or let me resign. That's all."

"Had Livesey not been here I should have seen you to the devil," cried the squire.

"As it is, I will do as you desire, but I think worse of you."

"As you please, sir," said the captain.

"You'll find I do my duty." And with that he left.

"Trelawney," said the doctor, "I believe you have two honest men on board – that man and John Silver."

"Silver, if you like," cried the squire, "but as for Smollett, I think his conduct unmanly, unsailorly, and downright un-English."

"Well," says the doctor, "we shall see."

When we came on deck, the men had begun already to take out the arms and powder.

The new arrangement was quite to my liking. Six berths had been made astern, and this set of cabins was only joined to the galley and forecastle by a passage on the port side. Originally, the captain, Mr. Arrow, Hunter, Joyce, the doctor and the squire were to occupy these berths. Now Redruth and I were to get two of them, and Mr. COMPANION Arrow and the captain were to sleep on deck in the companion, which had been enlarged on each part of the deck. side. Even the mate seemed pleased with the arrangement. He, too, may have been doubtful as to the crew, but that is only a guess, for we had not long the benefit of his opinion.

We were all hard at work changing the powder and berths when the last man or two, and Long John, came in a shore boat.

The cook came up the side like a monkey.

"So ho, mates!" says he, "what's this?"

"We're moving the powder," answers one.

"Ship's boy, off with you to the cook and get some work."

"If we do, we'll miss the morning tide!" cried Long John.

"My orders!" said the captain.

"You may go below, my man. Hands will want supper."

"Ay, ay, sir," answered the cook, touching his fore-

lock and disappearing in the direction of his galley. Then to me the captain cried: "Ship's boy, off with you to the cook and get some work." As I hurried off I heard him say to

the doctor: "I'll have no favorites on my ship."

I agreed with the squire, and hated the captain deeply.

Chapter 10 - The Voyage

That night we stowed things in their place, and the squire's friends came to wish him a good sounded his pipe, and the crew began to man the capstan bars. All was so new and inter-A whistle used to whistle, the men bustling to their places in signal various commands "Give us a verse," cried someone.

"Ay, ay, mates," said Long John, who at once

"Fifteen men on the dead man's

ship's anchor chest."

"Yo-ho-ho, and a bottle of rum!"

At the third "ho!" they drove the bars before them. Soon the anchor was dripping at the bow, the sails began to draw, and the Hispaniola had begun her voyage to Treasure Island.

I am not going to relate that voyage in detail. The ship proved to be a good ship, the crew and captain very capable. But two or three things happened that should be known.

Mr. Arrow, first of all, turned out worse than the captain had feared. He had no command among the men. And after a day or two he began to appear on deck with hazy eyes, stuttering tongue, and other marks of drunkenness. Time after time he was ordered below in disgrace. Sometimes he lay all day in his bunk, sometimes he would be almost sober and attend to his work at least passably.

We could never make out where he got the drink. When asked, he would only laugh, if he were drunk, and if he were sober, deny solemnly that he drank anything but water.

He was a bad influence on the men as well. Nobody was much surprised, nor very sorry, when one dark night he disappeared entirely.

"Overboard! Well," said the captain, "that saves the trouble of putting him in irons."

The boatswain, Job Anderson, served as mate, though he kept his old title. Mr. Trelawney's knowledge of the sea allowed him to take a watch himself in easy weather. And the coxswain, Israel Hands, was a wily, experienced seaman who could be trusted in a pinch with almost anything. He was a great confidant of Long John Silver, and the mention of his name leads me to speak of our ship's cook, Barbecue, as the men called him.

Aboard ship he carried his crutch by a lanyard round his neck, to have both hands as free as possible. It was something to see him prop against his crutch and yield to every movement of the ship, and get on with his cooking. In the heaviest weather, he had lines rigged up to help him cross the deck. He would hand himself from one place to another as quickly as another man could walk.

"He's no common man, Barbecue," said the coxswain to me.

“He can speak like a book when he wants. And brave – a lion’s nothing alongside him! I seen him, unarmed, grapple four men and knock their heads together.”

All the crew respected and obeyed him. He had a way of talking to each, and doing everybody some particular service. He was always glad to see me in the galley, which he kept as clean as a pin, the dishes hanging up burnished, and his parrot in a cage in one corner.

“Come have a yarn with me, Hawkins. Here’s Cap’n Flint – I calls my parrot after the famous buccaneer – here’s Cap’n Flint predicting success to our voyage.

Wasn’t you, cap’n?” And the parrot would say, with great rapidity, “Pieces of eight! Pieces of eight! Pieces of eight!” until John threw his handkerchief over the cage.

“That bird is maybe two hundred years old,” said Silver.

“If anybody’s seen more wickedness, it must be the devil himself. She sailed with the great Cap’n England, the pirate. It’s there she learned ‘Pieces of Eight,’ and little wonder – three-hundred-fifty-thousand of ‘em, Hawkins!”

“Stand by to go about,” the parrot would scream.

“She’s a handsome craft,” the cook would add, and give her sugar from his pocket. Then the bird would peck at the bars and swear. And Long John would touch his forelock with a solemn way that made me think he was the best of men.

In the meantime, the squire and Captain Smollett were still on distant terms with one another. The squire despised the captain. The captain never spoke except when spoken to, and then short and dry, not a word wasted. He admitted that he seemed to have been wrong about the crew. As for the ship, he had taken a downright fancy to her.

“She’ll lie a point nearer the wind than a man has a right to expect of his own wife, sir. But,” he would add, “I don’t like the cruise.”

“A trifle more of that man,” the squire would say, “and I shall explode.” proved the qualities of the Hispaniola. Every

Alcohol, especially man on board seemed well-content. Double grog rum. was given on the least excuse. There was duff if the squire heard it was anyone’s birthday, and a barrel of Pudding “Never knew good come of it yet,” the made with flour. make devils.” But good did come of the apple barrel. This is how it came about.

It was the last day of our outward voyage. Sometime before noon of the morrow, we should sight Treasure Island. After sundown, when all my work was over, it occurred to me that I would like an apple. The watch was all forward looking out for the island. The man at the helm was watching the sails and whistling gently to himself, and that was the only sound except the swish of the sea against the ship.

I got inside the apple barrel, and found scarce an apple left. But sitting down there in the dark, I was on the point of falling asleep, when a man sat down close by. It was Silver. Before I had heard a dozen words, I lay there listening in extreme fear and curiosity, for from their conversation I realized that the lives of all the honest men aboard depended upon me alone. the man at the helm was watching the sails and whistling gently to himself.

Chapter 11 - What I Heard in the Apple Barrel

No, not I,” said Silver.

“Flint was cap’n, I was quartermaster. The same broadside I lost my leg, old Pew lost his deadlights. I laid by after Flint – all safe in the bank. It’s not earning, but saving that does it. Where’s all England’s men now? I and glad to get the duff – been begging before that, some of ‘em. Old Pew, where is he now? Dead and buried.”

“Well, it ain’t much use, after all,” said the young seaman.

“It ain’t much use for fools, nothing is,” cried

Silver.

“Look here: you’re young, but you’re as smart as paint. I see that when I set my eyes on you, and I’ll talk to you like a man.”

When I heard him address another in the very same words of flattery he had used on me, I wanted to kill him. But unaware that I was listening, he continued.

“Gentlemen of fortune lives rough, and they risk hanging. But they eat and drink like fighting cocks, and when a cruise is done, why it’s hundreds of farthings in their pockets. Most goes for rum and a good fling. But that’s not the course I lay. I puts it all away, some here, some there. I’m fifty years old. Once back from this cruise, I set up as a gentleman. But I’ve lived easy in the meantime.

I never denied myself anything and slept soft and ate dainty, but when at sea. And how did I begin? Before the mast, like you!”

“Well,” said the other, “But all the other money’s gone now, ain’t it? You daren’t show your face in Bristol after this.”

“It were in Bristol when we weighed anchor,” said the cook.

“But my old missis has it all by now. And the “Spyglass” is sold and the old girl’s off to meet me. I would tell you where, for I trust you, but it would make jealousy among the mates.”

“Can you trust your missis?” asked the other.

“Gentlemen of fortune,” returned the cook, “usu-

ally don’t trust each other, and right they are about that. But I have a way with me. Some was feared of Pew, and some of Flint, but Flint himself was feared of me. You may be sure of yourself on old John’s ship.”

“Well, now,” replied the lad, “I didn’t like the job till this talk with you, John. Here’s my hand on it.”

“A brave lad you are, and smart, too,” answered

Silver.

“And a finer figurehead for a gentleman of fortune I never saw.”

By this time I had begun to understand the meaning of their terms. By a “gentleman of fortune” they meant a common pirate, and I had just overheard the last act in the corruption of one of the honest hands. Silver gave a little whistle and a third man joined them.

“Dick’s square,” said Silver.

“Oh, I knew Dick was square,” returned the voice of the coxswain, Israel Hands.

“He’s no fool.” And he spat his quid of tobacco.

“Here’s what I want to know,

Barbecue: when will we strike? I’ve had enough o’ Cap’n Smollett. He’s bothered me long enough, by thunder! I want to go into that cabin for their pickles and wines.”

“Listen, Israel. You berth forward, live hard, speak soft, and keep sober till I give the word.”

“I don’t say no, but I say, when?” growled the coxswain.

“At the last moment I can manage, that’s when,” cried Silver.

“Here’s a first-rate seaman, sails the blessed ship for us. Here’s this squire and doctor with a map. They shall find the stuff, and help us to get it aboard. If I was sure of you all, I’d have Cap’n Smollett navigate us half way back again before I struck. But I know the sort you are. I’ll finish with ‘em at the island, as soon as the treasure’s on board, and a pity it is.

“If you would only lay your course and stick to it, you would ride in carriages,” said Long John.

“But not you! You’ll have your mouthful of rum tomorrow and go hang.”

“But,” asked Dick, “what are we to do with ‘em, anyhow?”

“Well, what would you think?” cried the cook.

“Put ‘em ashore like maroons? That was England’s way. Or cut ‘em down like that much pork? That would have been Flint’s or Billy Bones’s.”

“Billy was the man for that,” said Israel.

“‘Dead men don’t bite,’ says he. If ever a rough man came to port, it was Billy.”

“Rough and ready,” said Silver.

“But I’m an easy man, quite the gentleman. But duty is duty, mates. I give my vote – death. When I’m in Parliament riding in my coach, I don’t want these men coming home, unlooked for, like the devil at prayers. Wait, but when the time comes, let her rip!

I claim Trelawney. I’ll wring his head off. Dick!” he added, breaking off, “jump up like a sweet lad, and get me an apple to wet my pipe.”

I was terrified! I heard Dick begin to rise, and then the voice of Hands exclaimed: “Leave it, John! Let’s have some rum.”

“Dick,” said Silver, “I trust you. I’ve a gauge on the keg, mind. There’s the key; you bring a cup up.”

Terrified as I was, I could not help thinking that this must have been how Mr. Arrow got the drink that destroyed him. When Dick returned, each took the cup and drank—one “to luck,” another “to old flint.”

During Dick’s absence, Israel spoke in the cook’s ear. I could catch only a word or two, yet I gathered important news: “No other man will join.” There were still faithful men on board.

When Dick returned, each took the cup and drank – one “To luck,” another “To old Flint.”

Just then, brightness fell upon me in the barrel, and, looking up, I found the moon had risen. Soon the voice of the lookout shouted, “Land ho!”

Chapter 12 - Council of War

There was a rush of feet across the deck. Slipping out of my barrel, I dived behind a sail and came out on the open deck in time to join. To the southwest we saw two low hills, and rising behind one of them a third and higher hill, whose peak was Captain Smollett was issuing orders. The Hispaniola now sailed a course that would just clear the “Men,” said the captain, when the sails were set, “has any of you ever seen the land ahead?”

“I have, sir,” said Silver.

“I’ve watered there with a trader I was cook in.”

“The anchorage is on the south, behind an islet, I fancy?” asked the captain.

“Yes, sir. Skeleton Island they calls it. It were a main place for pirates once. There are three hills running south. The big one with the cloud on it they calls Spyglass, because it was a lookout they kept when they were cleaning their ships.”

“I have a chart here,” says Captain Smollett.

“See if that’s the place.”

Long John’s eyes burned as he took the chart. But by the fresh look of the paper, I knew this was not the map we found in Billy Bones’s chest. It was a copy, complete in all things except the red crosses and written notes. Silver hid his disappointment.

“Yes, sir,” said he, “this is the spot, and very pret-

tily drawn out. Who might have done that, I wonder? Ay, here it is: ‘Capt. Kidd’s Anchorage.’ A strong current runs along the south, and then north up the west coast. Right you was, sir,” says he, “to keep the weather of the island. Leastways, if such was your intention as to enter and careen, there ain’t no better place in these Leans a ship over, usually on a beach, to clean or repair its with which John avowed his knowledge hull. of the island. He did not know that I had overheard him from the apple barrel. I had, by this time, such a horror of his cruelty, duplicity, and power, that I could scarce conceal a shudder when he laid his hand upon my arm.

“This island is a sweet spot for a lad,” he said.

“When you want to do a bit of exploring, just ask old John, and he’ll put up a snack for you to take along.” Clapping me on the shoulder, he hobbled off and went below.

Captain Smollett, the squire, and Dr. Livesey were talking together on the quarterdeck, and anxious as I was to tell them my story, I dared not interrupt them openly. While I was still thinking of a good excuse, Dr. Livesey called me. He had left his pipe below, and being a slave to tobacco, meant that I should fetch it. But as soon as I was near enough to speak and not be overheard, I broke out immediately: “Doctor, get the captain and squire down to the cabin, and then send for me. I have terrible news.”

The doctor’s expression changed a little, but the next moment he was master of himself.

“Thank you, Jim,” said he, quite loudly, “that was all I wanted to know,” as if he had asked a question. Then he rejoined the other two. Soon the captain gave an order to Job Anderson, and all hands were piped on deck.

“My lads,” said Captain Smollett, “This land that we have sighted is the place we have been sailing for. I have told Mr. Trelawney that every man on board has done his duty, as I never ask to see it done better. We are going below to the cabin to drink to your health and luck, and you’ll have grog to drink to our health and luck. Let’s give a good sea cheer for the squire.”

The cheer that followed rang out so hearty that I could hardly believe these same men were plotting for our blood. Then the gentlemen went below, and not long after, I was sent for.

I found them seated round the table, a bottle of wine and some raisins before them, and the doctor smoking away, with his wig on his lap, and that, I knew, was a sign that he was agitated.

“let’s give a good sea cheer for the squire.”

“Now, Hawkins,” said the squire, “Speak up.” As short as I could make it, I told the details of Silver’s conversation. Nobody interrupted me from first “Captain,” said the squire, “you were right and I “I never heard of a crew that meant to mutiny that didn’t show signs of mischief before,” said the captain.

“This crew beats me.”

“Captain,” said the doctor, “with your permission, that’s Silver. A remarkable man.”

“I see three or four points,” returned the captain.

“First, we can’t turn back. If I gave the word to go back, they would rise at once. Second, we have time, at least, until this treasure’s found. Third, it’s got to come to blows sooner or later, and what I propose is, to choose our time to fight when they least expect it. We can count on your own servants, Mr. Trelawney?”

“As upon myself,” declared the squire.

“Three,” reckoned the captain, “ourselves make seven, counting Hawkins. Now, about the honest hands.”

“Most likely Trelawney’s own men,” said the doctor, “those he had picked up for himself, before he lit on Silver.”

“Nay,” replied the squire.

“Hands was mine.”

“Well, gentlemen,” said the captain, “we must keep a lookout. But we must wait till we know the men we can count on.”

“Jim,” said the doctor, “can help us more than anyone. The men are not shy with him, and he is a noticing lad.”

“Hawkins, I put a lot of faith in you,” added the squire.

I felt helpless, and yet, by an odd train of circumstances, it was indeed through me that safety came. In the meantime, there were only seven out of the twenty-six on whom we knew we could rely, and out of these seven, one was a boy.

Part III

Chapter 13 - How I Began My Shore Adventure

WE WERE NOW LYING BECALMED about half a mile southeast of the low eastern coast. The naked rock. The Spyglass ran up sheer from almost every side, and then suddenly cut off at the top like a pedestal to The Hispaniola was creaking, groaning, and jumping in the ocean swell. The world turned giddily before my eyes, for though I was a good enough sailor, this being rolled about like a bottle was unsettling, above all in the morning, on an empty stomach.

Perhaps it was the look of the island, with its grey, melancholy woods and wild stone spires, and the surf foaming and thundering on the steep beach. You would have thought anyone would have been glad to get to land after being so long at sea, but my heart sank into my boots. From that first look, I hated Treasure Island.

There was no wind, and the boats had to be manned and the ship pulled round the corner of the island, and up the narrow passage to the haven. I volunteered for one of the boats, where I had, of course, no business. The heat was sweltering, and the men grumbled. Anderson was in command of my boat, and instead of keeping order, he grumbled as loud as the worst.

“Well,” he said, swearing, “it’s not forever.”

I thought this was a very bad sign, for up to that day, the men had gone willingly about their business. The very sight of the island had relaxed the cords of discipline.

All the way in, Long John stood by the steersman and directed the ship. He knew the passage like the palm of his hand, and though the man in the chains got everywhere more water than was down in the chart, John never hesitated once. CHAINS

We brought up just where the anchor was in the chart, about a third of a mile from

either shore, the mainland on one side, and Skeleton Island on the other.

The trees came right down to the highwater mark, the shores were mostly flat, and the hilltops formed a sort of amphitheater. Two little swamps emptied out into this pond, as you might call it, and the foliage round that part of the shore had a kind of poisonous brightness. There was not a breath of air moving. A peculiar stagnant smell hung over the anchorage, a smell of sodden leaves and rotting tree trunks. I observed the doctor sniffing like someone tasting a bad egg.

"I don't know about treasure," he said, "but I'll stake my wig there's fever here."

The conduct of the men became truly threatening. The slightest order was received with a black look, and grudgingly obeyed. Even the honest hands must have been affected. Mutiny hung over us like a thundercloud.

Long John saw the danger as well, and was hard at work going from group to group, giving advice. No man could have shown a better example. If an order were given, John would be on his crutch in an instant with the cheeriest, "Ay, ay, sir!" in the world. When there was nothing else to do, he sang, as if to conceal the discontent of the rest.

We held a council in the cabin.

"Sir," said the captain, "I dare not risk another order. If I get a rough answer and speak back, pikes will be going in two shakes. If I don't, Silver will suspect something, and the game's up. We have only one man to rely on.

"And who is that?" asked the squire.

"Silver," said the captain.

"He's as anxious as you and I to cover things up. He'd soon talk them out of it if he had the chance. Let's allow the men an afternoon ashore. If some go, sir, Silver'll bring 'em aboard again as mild as lambs."

Loaded pistols were served out to all the sure men. Hunter, Joyce and Redruth were taken into our confidence, and received the news with less surprise than we had looked for. Then the captain went on deck and addressed the crew.

"Lads," said he, "we've had a hot day, and are all tired and out of sorts. As many as would like may take the gigs ashore for the afternoon. I'll fire a gun half an hour before sundown." ed, for they all came out of their sulks in GIG The captain whipped out of sight, A light, narrow ship's leaving Silver to arrange the party. Had he boat. been on deck, he could no longer pretend not to understand the situation. It was as plain as day. Silver was the captain, and a mighty rebellious crew he At last the party was made up. Six men were to stay on board, and the remaining thirteen, including Silver, If six men were left by Silver, it was plain our party could not take the ship. It occurred to me at once to go ashore. In a jiffy I slipped over the side and curled up in the nearest boat, almost at the same moment she i swung myself out and plunged into the nearest thicket.

Silver, from the other boat, called out to know if that were me, and from that moment I began to regret what I had done.

The crews raced for the beach, but the boat I was in shot far ahead. The bow struck

among the shore side trees, and I swung myself out and plunged into the nearest thicket, while Silver and the rest were still a hundred yards behind.

“Jim! Jim!” I heard him shouting. But I paid no heed. Jumping, ducking, and breaking through, I ran till I could run no longer.

Chapter 14 - The First Blow

I was so pleased at having given the slip to Long John that I began to enjoy myself and look around on the strange land that I was in. I had crossed a marshy tract full of bullrushes and come out upon a sandy area

I now felt the joy of exploration. There were flowering plants, unknown to me, and snakes – one raised his head. Then I came to a long thicket of oak-like trees called live oaks, which grew low along the sand like brambles, the boughs twisted, the foliage compact, like thatch. The thicket stretched to the margin of the broad, reedy marsh through which the nearest of the little rivers soaked its way into the anchorage.

Suddenly, a wild duck flew up with a quack, another followed, and soon a great cloud of birds hung screaming and circling in the air above the marsh. I judged at once that some of my shipmates must be near. Soon I heard the tones of a human voice, growing steadily louder.

I crawled under cover of the nearest live oak, and squatted there, as silent as a mouse. Another voice answered, and then the first voice, which I recognized to be Silver's, once more took up the story.

I could tell the direction of the speakers pretty exactly, not only by the sound of their voices, but by the behavior of the few birds that still hung in alarm above the intruders.

Crawling on all fours, I made steadily towards them, till at last, raising my head to an opening among the leaves, I could see Silver and another of the crew face to face.

“Mate,” Silver was saying, “it’s because I think gold dust of you that I am here warning you. If one of the wild ’uns knew it, where would I be, Tom?”

“Silver,” said the other man – his voice shaking –

“you’re old, and you’re honest, or has the name for it. You’ve money, too, and you’re brave. You’ll let yourself be led away with these swabs? Not you! As sure as God sees me, I’d sooner lose my hand. If I turn agin my duty – ” And then all of a sudden he was interrupted by a noise. I had found one of the honest hands, and at that same moment came news of another. From the marsh there arose a cry of anger, then another on the back of it, and then one horrid scream. The rocks of the Spyglass echoed it. The marsh birds rose again, and while that death yell was still in my brain, silence re-established its empire, and only the rustle of descending birds and the boom of distant waves disturbed the afternoon.

Tom leaped at the sound, but Silver winked not an eye. He stood resting lightly on his crutch, watching like a snake about to spring.

“John!” said Tom, stretching out his hand.

“Hands off!” cried Silver, leaping back a yard.

“It’s a black conscience that makes you fear me, John Silver. In heaven’s name, tell me, what was that?”

“That?” returned Silver, smiling but wary, his eye gleaming.

“Oh, I reckon that’ll be Alan.”

“Alan!” Tom cried.

“Rest his soul! And as for you,

John Silver, you’re my mate no more. If I die like a dog, I’ll die in my duty. You’ve killed Alan? Kill me, too, if you can. But I defy you.” And with that, this brave fellow turned his back on the cook, and set off toward the beach. But he was not destined to go far. John seized a branch, whipped the crutch out of his armpit, and sent that missile hurtling through the air. It struck poor Tom with stunning violence right between the shoulders in the middle of his back. His hands flew up, he gave a gasp, and fell.

To judge from the sound, his back was broken on the spot. But he had no time to recover. Silver, agile as a monkey, even without leg or crutch, was on top of him in a moment, and had twice buried his knife up to the hilt in that defenseless body.

The world swam around me in a whirling mist. When I came to, the monster had pulled himself together, his crutch under his arm, his hat upon his head. Just before him, Tom lay motionless, but the murderer minded him not a whit, cleaning his blood-stained knife on a wisp of grass. Silver was on top of him in a moment, and had twice buried his knife up to the hilt in that defenseless body.

It seemed unreal that a human life had been cruelly cut short a moment since, before my eyes.

Now John blew a signal on his whistle that rang far across the heated air. It instantly awoke my fears. More men would be coming. I might be discovered. They had already slain two of the honest people – might not I come next? As soon as I was clear of the thicket, I ran as I never ran before, scarce minding the direction of my flight, so long as it led me from the murderers. My fear grew into a kind of frenzy. It was all over, I thought.

Nothing was left for me but death by starvation, or by the hands of the mutineers.

All this while, running without taking notice, I had drawn near the foot of the little hill with the two peaks, where the live oaks seemed more like forest trees. Here a fresh alarm brought me to a standstill with a thumping heart.

Chapter 15 - The Man of the Island

From the side of the hill, which was steep and stony, gravel was dislodged, and fell rattling and I saw a figure leap behind the trunk of a pine. It seemed dark and shaggy, whether bear or man or monkey, I could not tell. But the terror of this new apparition

I was now cut off on both sides. Behind me were the murderers, before me this lurking creature, which reappeared and began to head me off. I was tired, and I could see it

was in vain for me to contend with such an adversary.

From trunk to trunk the creature flitted like a deer, running manlike on two legs, but stooping almost double as it ran. Yet a man it was; I could no longer be in doubt about that.

I began to recall what I had heard of cannibals. I nearly called for help. But the fact that he was a man, however wild, somewhat reassured me. I remembered my pistol, and that I was not defenseless, and courage glowed in my heart. I walked briskly towards this man of the island.

He was concealed, by this time, behind another tree trunk, but he must have been watching me closely, for as soon as I began to move in his direction he reappeared and took a step to meet me. To my confusion, he threw himself on his knees and held out his hands.

“Who are you?” I asked.

“Ben Gunn,” he said. His voice sounded like a rusty lock.

“Poor Ben Gunn I am, and I haven’t spoke with a Christian for three years.”

I could now see that he was a white man like myself. His skin was burnt by the sun, even his lips were black, and his fair eyes looked quite startling in so dark a face. He was clothed with tatters of old canvas, held together by an odd system of brass buttons and bits of stick.

“Three years!” I cried.

“Were you shipwrecked?”

“Nay, mate,” said he, “marooned.” I knew this was a horrible kind of punishment common among buccaneers, in which the offender is left behind on some desolate island.

“Marooned three years ago,” he continued, “and lived on goats, and berries, and oysters. Wherever a man is, says I, a man can do for himself. But, mate, my heart is sore for a Christian diet. Many’s the night I’ve dreamed of cheese.”

All this time he had been feeling my jacket, looking at my boots, and generally showing a childish pleasure in the presence of a fellow creature.

“What do you call yourself, mate?”

“Jim,” I told him.

“Well, now, Jim,” he said.

“I’ve lived so rough as you’d be ashamed to hear of it. You wouldn’t think I had a pious mother, to look at me. But I was a pious boy “i’m poor ben gunn, marooned three years ago, and lived on goats, and berries, and oysters.” and could rattle off my catechism. It were Providence that put me here. I’ve thought it all out in this lonely island, and I’m back on piety. You don’t catch me tasting rum, but just a thimbleful for luck, of course, the first chance I have. I’m bound I’ll be good. And, Jim” – looking around him, and lowering his voice to a whisper – “I’m rich. You’ll bless your stars you was the first that found me!”

He tightened his grasp upon my hand, and raised a forefinger threateningly before my eyes.

“Now, Jim, you tell me true: that ain’t Flint’s ship?” he asked.

At this I began to believe that I had found an ally, and I answered him at once.

“It’s not Flint’s ship, and Flint is dead, but there are some of Flint’s hands aboard.”

“Not a man – with one – leg?” he gasped.

“Silver?” I asked.

“Ah, Silver, that were his name,” he said.

“He’s the cook and the ringleader, too.”

I told him the whole story of our voyage, and the predicament in which we found ourselves. He heard me with the keenest interest, and when I was finished he patted me on the head.

“And you’re in a clove hitch, ain’t you?” he said.

“Well, you just put your trust in Ben Gunn. Would you think it likely the squire would prove liberal-minded in case of help?”

I said the squire was the most liberal of men.

“Would he be likely to offer one A sailor’s knot, thousand pounds of money that’s as good as a man’s own already?”

“I’m sure he would,” said I.

“And a passage home?” he added, with a look of great shrewdness.

“Why,” I cried, “the squire’s a gentleman. And besides, if we got rid of the others, we should want you to help work the vessel.”

He seemed very much relieved.

“Now, I’ll tell you what,” he went on.

“I were in Flint’s ship when he buried the treasure – he and six strong men. They were ashore nigh on a week, and us standing off in the old Walrus. One day up went the signal, and here come Flint by himself in a little boat. There he was and the six all dead – dead and buried. How he done it, not a man aboard could make out.

Billy Bones was the mate. Long John was quartermaster, and they asked him where the treasure was. ‘Ah,’ says he, ‘you stay ashore, if you like,’ he says, ‘but as for the ship, she’ll beat up for more, by thunder!’

“Well, I was in another ship three years back, and we sighted this island. ‘Boys,’ said I, ‘here’s Flint’s treasure. Let’s find it.’ The cap’n was displeased, but my messmates were all of a mind. Twelve days they looked for it, until one fine morning all hands went aboard. ‘As for you, Benjamin Gunn,’ says they, ‘here’s a musket, and a spade, and a pickaxe. You can stay here and find

Flint’s money for yourself.’ “Well, Jim, do I look like a man before the mast? I weren’t. Just you mention these words to your squire, Jim: Three years he were the man of this island, and sometimes he would think on a prayer, and sometimes think of his old

mother, but most of Gunn's time was took up with another matter."

"But how am I to get on board?" I said.

"There's my boat, that I made with my two hands," he said.

"I keep her under the white rock. If worst comes to worst, we might try that after dark."

Then, suddenly, the echoes of the island bellowed to the thunder of a cannon.

"They have begun to fight!" I cried. I began to run towards the anchorage, my terrors forgotten, while, close at my side, the marooned man trot- "Keep to your left, Jim! Under the trees! There's the cemetery. I come here and prayed when I thought it might

He kept talking, neither expecting or receiving any

Then, in front of me, I beheld the

Part IV

Chapter 16 - How the Ship Was Abandoned

Narrative Continued by the Doctor:

It was about half-past one when the two gigs went ashore. The captain, the squire, and I were talking matters over in the cabin. Had there been a breath of wind, we should have fallen on the six mutineers left aboard with us and slipped away to sea. But there was no wind, and, to complete our helplessness, Hunter came with With the men in the temper they were in, it seemed an even chance if we should see the lad again.

We ran on deck. The pitch was bubbling in the seams. The stench of the place turned me sick. If ever a man smelt fever and dysentery, it was in that anchorage. The six scoundrels were grumbling in the forecastle. Ashore we could see the gigs made fast, and a man sitting in each.

Waiting was a strain, and it was decided that Hunter and I should go ashore with the jolly boat . We pulled straight in the direction of the stockade upon the chart. The two who were left guarding A small their boats seemed in a bustle at our appearance. I could see the pair discussing what they ought to do. Had they told Silver, all might have turned out differently, but they decided to sit quietly where they were.

There was a slight bend in the coast, and I steered so as to put it between us. Even before we landed we had lost sight of the gigs. I jumped out and ran, a brace of pistols primed for safety.

I had not gone a hundred yards when I reached the stockade. This was how it was: a spring of clear water rose almost at the top of a knoll. On the knoll, enclosing the spring, they had clapped a stout loghouse, fit to hold forty people in a pinch, and loopholed for musketry on every side. Around this they had cleared a wide space and put up a fence six feet high, without a guns can be door or opening, too strong to pull down and too open to shelter the attackers. The people in the log-house had them in every way. All they wanted

was a good watch and food, for short of a complete surprise, they might have held the place against a regiment.

What particularly took my fancy was the spring. For, though on the Hispaniola we had plenty of arms and ammunition, and things to eat, and wines, there had been one thing overlooked – we had no water. I was thinking this over, when there came ringing over the island the cry of a man at the point of death. I was not new to violent death.

“Jim Hawkins is gone,” was my first thought.

With no time to lose, I made up my mind instantly and jumped on board the jolly boat. Hunter pulled a good oar and we were soon aboard the schooner.

I found them all shaken, as was natural. The squire was sitting down, as white as a sheet, thinking of the harm he had led us to, and one of the six forecastle hands was little better.

“There’s a man,” says Captain Smollett, nod-

ding towards him, “new to his work. He nearly fainted when he heard the cry. Another touch of the rudder and he’ll join us.”

I told my plan to the captain, and we settled on the details of its accomplishment. We put old Redruth in the gallery between the cabin and the forecastle, with three loaded muskets and a mattress for protection. Hunter brought the boat round under the stern, and Joyce and I loaded her with powder, muskets, bags of biscuits, kegs of pork, a cask of cognac and my medicine chest.

In the meantime, the captain hailed the coxswain, who was the principal man aboard.

“Mr. Hands,” he said, “if any one of your six makes a signal, that man’s dead.”

They were taken aback, and, after a little consultation, all tumbled down the companion, thinking to take us from the rear. But when they saw Redruth wait- “down, dog!” cried the captain. ing for them, they went about at once, and a head popped out again on deck.

“Down, dog!” cried the captain.

The head popped back again, and we heard no more from these faint-hearted seamen.

By this time, we had the jolly boat loaded. Joyce and I made for shore again, as fast as oars could take us.

This second trip aroused the watchers along shore. Just before we lost sight of them behind the little point, one of them whipped ashore and disappeared. I had a mind to destroy their boats, but I feared that Silver and the others might be close, and all might be lost by trying too much.

We soon touched land again, and set to provision the blockhouse. All three made the first journey, heavily laden, and we tossed our stores over the palisade. Leaving Joyce to guard them – one man, but with half a dozen muskets – Hunter and I returned to the jolly boat and loaded ourselves once more. We proceeded till the whole cargo was stowed. Then the men took up their position in the blockhouse, and I sculled back to the Hispaniola. That we should have risked a second boatload seems more daring than it really was. They had the

advantage of numbers, but we had the advantage of arms. Not one of the men ashore had a musket.

The squire was waiting for me at the stern window. He made the rope fast, and we loaded the boat for our very lives. Pork, powder, and biscuit was the cargo, with only a musket and a cutlass apiece for the squire and me and Redruth and the captain. The rest of the arms and powder we dropped overboard. We could see the bright steel shining far below on the clean, sandy bottom.

Redruth dropped into the boat, which we then brought round to Captain Smollett.

"Now, men," said he, "do you hear me?"

There was no answer from the forecastle.

"It's to you, Abraham Gray, I am speaking."

Still no reply.

"Gray," resumed Mr. Smollett, a little louder, "I am leaving this ship, and I order you to follow your captain. I know you are a good man at bottom, and I daresay not one of the lot of you's as bad as he makes out. I give you thirty seconds to join me. Come. I'm risking my life and the lives of these good gentlemen, every second."

There was a scuffle, and out burst Abraham Gray with a knife cut on his cheek.

"I'm with you, sir," said he. And the next moment he and the captain had dropped aboard, and we had shoved off.

Chapter 17 - The Jolly Boat's Last Trip

On this fifth trip the little boat was gravely overloaded. Five grown men, and three of tain – over six feet high, was already more than she was meant to carry. Add to that the powder, pork, water, and my breeches and the tails of my coat were soaking wet before we had gone a hundred yards.

Even ripples were a danger to our overloaded craft. But the worst of it was that we were swept away from our proper landing place behind the point.

"I cannot keep her head for the stockade, sir," said I to the captain. I was steering, while he and Redruth were at the oars.

"The tide keeps washing her down. Could you pull stronger?"

"Not without swamping the boat," said he.

The tide kept sweeping us westward until I had laid her head due east, or just about at right angles to the way we ought to go.

"We'll never get ashore at this rate," said I.

"It's our only course," returned the captain.

"The current must slacken, and then we can dodge back along the shore."

"The current's less already, sir," said Gray, "you can ease her off a bit."

“Thank you, my man,” said I, for we had all made up our minds to treat him like one of us.

Suddenly the captain spoke up again.

“The gun!” said he.

We had entirely forgotten the long nine, and there, to our horror, were the five rogues busy removing her cover.

“Israel was Flint’s gunner,” NINE head direct for the landing place. By this time A longwe were so far out of the current that with pound balls. But the worst of it was, that with the course I now held, we turned our broadside to the Hispaniola and offered a target like a barn door.

“Who’s the best shot?” asked the captain.

“Mr. Trelawney, by far,” said I.

“Mr. Trelawney, pick me off one of these men, sir.

Hands, if possible,” said the captain. Trelawney was as cool as steel. He looked to the priming of his gun.

“Now,” cried the captain, “easy with that gun, sir, or you’ll swamp the boat. All hands stand by to trim her when he aims.”

The squire raised his gun, the rowing ceased, and we leaned over the other side to keep the balance. They had the gun, by this time, brought round upon the swivel, and Hands, who was at the muzzle, was the most exposed. But we had no luck, for just as Trelawney fired, down he stooped. The ball whistled over him, and it was one of the other four who fell.

The cry he gave was echoed, not only by his companions on board, but by voices on the shore. I saw the pirates trooping out from among the trees and tumbling into the boats.

“Here come the gigs, sir,” said I.

“Give way, then,” cried the captain.

“If we can’t get ashore, all’s up.”

“Only one of the gigs is being manned, sir,” I added.

“The crew of the other is most likely going round by shore to cut us off.”

“They’ll have a hot run, sir,” returned the captain.

“It’s not them I mind, it’s the shot!”

In the meanwhile we had been making headway at a good pace. Thirty or forty strokes and we should beach her. The ebb tide, which had so cruelly delayed us, was now delaying our assailants. The one source of danger was the gun. It was plain that they meant nothing should delay their shot. They never even looked at their “they’ll have a hot run, sir,” returned the captain.

“it’s not them i mind, it’s the shot!” fallen comrade, though he was not dead.

“Ready!” cried the squire.

“Hold!” cried the captain. And he and Redruth backed with a great heave that sent her stern under water. The report was the first that Jim heard, the sound of the squire’s shot not having reached him. I fancy the ball passed over our heads. The wind of it may have contributed to our disaster. The boat sank by the stern, quite gently, in three feet of water. No lives were lost, and we could wade ashore in safety. But our stores were at the bottom, and only two guns still worked. Mine I had held over my head. The captain had carried his over his shoulder, lock uppermost. The other three had gone down with the boat.

To add to our concern, we heard voices drawing near us in the woods along the shore. We had not only the danger of being cut off from the stockade, but the fear of whether Hunter and Joyce, if attacked, would stand firm. Hunter was steady. Joyce was doubtful – a pleasant, polite man, but not fitted for battle.

With all this in our minds, we waded ashore as fast as we could, leaving behind us the jolly boat, and half our powder and provisions.

Chapter 18 - End of the First Day’s Fighting

Narrative Continued by the Doctor:

We made our best speed across the strip of wood that now divided us from the stockade. At every step we took, the voices of the buccaneers rang nearer. We could hear the cracking of branches as they broke through a thicket. Soon we would have to “Captain,” said I, “Trelawney is the dead shot. Give him your gun. His own is useless.”

They exchanged guns, and Trelawney, silent and cool, made sure all was fit for service. At the same time, observing Gray to be unarmed, I handed him my cutlass. It did all our hearts good to see him spit in his hand, knit his brows, and make the blade sing through the air. It was plain from every line in his body that our new hand was his wages. worth his salt .

Forty paces farther we came to the edge of the wood and saw the stockade in front of us. Almost at the same time, seven mutineers appeared in full cry.

They paused, and before they recovered, not only the squire and I, but Hunter and Joyce from the blockhouse, had time to fire. The four shots came in a scattering volley, but they did the business. One of the enemy actually fell dead, and the rest turned and plunged into the trees.

After reloading, we walked outside the fence to see the fallen man. He was stone dead – shot through the heart.

We began to rejoice over our good success, when just at that moment a pistol cracked. A ball whistled past my ear, and Tom Redruth stumbled and fell to the ground. The squire and I returned the shot, but as we had nothing to aim at, it is probable we only wasted powder. Then we turned our attention to poor Tom.

The captain and Gray were examining him, and I saw that all was over. We managed to get Tom hoisted over the stockade, and carried, groaning and bleeding, into the loghouse.

Poor old fellow, he had not uttered one word of complaint or fear from the beginning

of our troubles. He had followed every order silently and well. Now he was to die.

The squire knelt beside him and kissed his hand, crying like a child.

“Be I going, doctor?” Tom asked.

“Tom,” said I, “you’re going home.”

“I wish I had a lick at them first,” he replied.

“Tom,” said the squire, “say you forgive me.”

“Would that be respectful, from me to you, squire?” was the answer.

“Howsoever, so be it.”

A little later, he said he thought somebody might read a prayer.

“It’s custom, sir,” he added, apologetically. Not long after, he passed away.

In the meantime the captain had turned out many objects from his coat pockets – the British flag, a Bible, a coil of rope, pen, ink, the logbook, and pounds of tobacco. Propping a felled tree against the log house with Hunter’s help, the captain climbed on the roof and ran up the flag.

This seemed to relieve him. He set about counting up the stores, as if nothing else existed. But he had an eye on Tom’s passage, and as soon as all was over, came forward with another flag and reverently spread it on the body.

“Don’t worry, sir,” he said, shaking the squire’s hand.

“All’s well with him. No fear for a hand that’s been shot down in his duty.” Then he pulled me aside.

“Dr. Livesey,” he said, “when do you expect the rescue boat?”

I told him that if we were not back by the end of August, Blandly was to send to find us.

“Yes,” said the captain, “even allowing for all the gifts of Providence, sir, I should say we were pretty close hauled. As for powder and shot, we’ll do. But the rations are so short.”

Just then, a round shot descended inside the stockade, scattering a cloud of sand.

“Captain,” said the squire, “the house is quite invisible from the ship. It must be the flag they are aiming at. Would it be wiser to take it in?”

“Take down my flag!” cried the captain.

“No, sir, not I.” And as soon as he had said the words, I think we all agreed with him. For it showed our enemies that we despised their cannonade.

All through the evening they thundered away. Ball after ball flew over or fell short, or kicked up sand in the enclosure, but they had to fire so high that the shot fell dead and buried itself in the soft sand.

“There is one thing good about all this,” observed the captain.

“The wood in front of us is likely clear. The ebb tide has probably uncovered our

stores.”

Gray and Hunter were the first to come forward, but it proved a useless mission. The mutineers were bolder than we fancied. For four or five of them were busy carrying off our stores to one of the gigs. Silver was in command, and every man was now provided with a musket from some secret supply of their own.

The captain sat down to his log, and here is the beginning of the entry: i ran to the door in time to see jim hawkins, safe and sound, climbing over the stockade.

“Alexander Smollett, master; David Livesey, ship’s doctor; Abraham Gray, carpenter’s mate; John Trelawney, owner; John Hunter and Richard Joyce, owner’s servants, landsmen – being all that is left faithful of the ship’s company – with stores for ten days at short rations, came ashore this day, and flew British colors on the log-house in Treasure Island. Thomas Redruth, owner’s servant, landsman, shot by the mutineers; James Hawkins, cabin boy – ” And at the same time I was wondering over poor Jim’s fate, came a hail on the land side.

“Doctor! Squire! Captain! Hullo, Hunter, is that you?” came the cries.

I ran to the door in time to see Jim Hawkins, safe and sound, climbing over the stockade.

Chapter 19 - The Garrison in the Stockade

Narrative Resumed by Jim Hawkins: As soon as Ben Gunn saw the colors he came to a halt, stopped me by the arm, and sat “Now,” said he, “there’s your friends, sure enough. In a place like this, where nobody puts in but gentlemen of fortune, Silver would fly the Jolly Roger . There’s been blows, and I reckon your friends has had the best of it. Here they are ashore in the stockade made long ago by Flint. Ah, “Well,” said I, “all the more reason JOLLY that I should hurry on and join my friends.”

A pirate “Nay, mate,” returned Ben.

“You’re flag. a good boy, but you’re only a boy, all told. Rum wouldn’t bring Ben Gunn where you’re going. Not till I see your born gentleman, and gets his word of honor.

“And when Ben Gunn is wanted, you know where to find him, Jim. Between noon and three. And him that comes is to have a white thing in his hand: and he’s to come alone.”

“I believe I understand,” I said.

“You have something to propose, and you wish to see the squire or the doctor, and you’re to be found where I found you.

Now may I go?”

“You won’t forget?” he inquired, anxiously.

“Well, then,” – still holding me – “I reckon you can go, Jim. And if you was to see Silver, you wouldn’t sell Ben Gunn? No, says you.”

At that moment a cannon ball came tearing through the trees and pitched in the sand,

not a hundred yards from us, and the two of us ran in different directions.

For an hour, balls kept crashing through the woods. Towards the end of the bombardment, I had begun to get courage again. After a detour to the east, I crept down among the shoreside trees.

The sun had just set. The tide was far out, and great tracts of sand lay uncovered. The Hispaniola still lay where she had anchored, but there was the Jolly Roger – the black flag of piracy – flying from her peak. Even as I looked, there came another red flash and another report that sent the echoes clattering, and one more shot whistled through the air. It was the last of the cannonade.

I lay for some time watching the men demolishing something with axes on the beach near the stockade. It was the jolly boat, I later discovered. Near the mouth of the river, a great fire glowed, and between that point and the ship one of the gigs kept coming and going. The men were shouting at their oars, and there was a sound in their voices which suggested rum.

I saw some distance further down, and rising from among low bushes, a high, isolated rock, peculiarly white in color. It occurred to me that this might be the white rock beneath which Ben Gunn had hidden his boat. Then I went through the woods until I had regained the rear, or shoreward side, of the stockade, and was warmly welcomed by the faithful party.

I had soon told my story and began to look about me. The log-house was made of trunks of pine – roof, walls, and floor. The latter stood in several places as much as a foot and a half above the sand. There was a porch at the door, and under this porch the little spring welled up into a great ship's iron kettle, with the bottom knocked out, and into the sand.

Little had been left beside the framework of the house, but in one corner there was a stone slab for a hearth, and an old rusty iron basket to contain the fire.

The slopes of the knoll and the inside of the stockade had been cleared of timber to build the house, and we could see by the stumps what a fine and lofty grove had been destroyed. Very close around the stockade – too close for defense – the wood still flourished high and dense.

The cold evening breeze whistled through every chink of the building, and sprinkled the floor with a continual rain of sand. There was sand in our eyes and our teeth, sand in our suppers, sand dancing in the spring at the bottom of the kettle. Our chimney was a square hole in the roof. Only a little smoke found its way out, and the rest stayed in the house and kept us coughing.

Add to this that Gray had his face tied up in a bandage for the cut he had got in breaking away, and poor old Tom Redruth lay along the wall, stiff and stark, under the Union Jack. If we had been allowed to sit idle, we should have all fallen in the blues, but Captain Smollett called us up before him and divided us into watches. The doctor, and Gray, and I, for one, the squire, Hunter, and Joyce, upon the other. Two were sent out for firewood, two more were set to dig a grave for Redruth, the doctor was named cook,

I was made sentry at the door, and the captain lent a hand wherever it was wanted.

From time to time the doctor came to the door for air and to rest his eyes from the

smoke. Whenever he did so, he had a word for me.

“That man Smollett,” he said once, “is a better man than I am, Jim.”

Another time he came and was silent for awhile. Then he put his head on one side and looked at me.

“Is Ben Gunn a man?” he asked.

“I don’t know, sir,” said I.

“I’m not very sure whether he’s sane.”

“If there’s any doubt about the matter, he is,” returned the doctor.

“A man who has been three years on a desert island can’t expect to appear as sane as you or me.

Was it cheese you said he had a fancy for?”

“Yes, sir, cheese,” I answered.

“Well,” says he, “in my snuff box I carry a piece of Parmesan cheese – made in Italy and very nutritious. That’s for Ben Gunn!”

Before supper we buried old Tom in the sand, and stood round him for awhile bareheaded. A good deal of firewood had been got in, but not enough for the captain. When we had eaten our pork, and had a stiff glass of brandy, the three chiefs got together in a corner to discuss our prospects.

They were at their wit’s end what to do, the stores being so low that we must be starved into surrender long before help came. Our best hope, it was decided, was to kill off the buccaneers until they either hauled down their before supper we buried old tom in the sand, and stood round him for awhile bareheaded. flag or ran away with the Hispaniola . From nineteen they were already reduced to fifteen, two others were wounded, and one – the man shot beside the gun – severely wounded, if not dead. Every time we had a crack at them, we were to take it. Besides that, we had twoable allies – rum and climate! As for the first, though we were half a mile away, we could hear them roaring late into the night. And as for the second, the doctor was sure that, camped where they were in the marsh, half of them would be sick within a week.

“So,” he added, “if we are not all shot down first, they’ll be glad to leave.”

“First ship ever I lost,” said Captain Smollett.

Everyone else had already breakfasted and increased the pile of firewood by about half as much again, when I was awakened by a bustle and the sound of voices.

“Flag of truce!” I heard someone say. And then, “Silver himself!”

And, at that, I jumped up, and rubbing my eyes, ran to an opening in the wall.

Chapter 20 - Silver’s Embassy

Sure enough, there were two men just outside the stockade, one of them waving a

white cloth. The It was still quite early, and a chill pierced into the marrow. The tops of the trees shone rosily in the sun, but where Silver stood with his lieutenant all was still in shadow, and they waded knee-deep in a low, white vapor.

“Keep indoors,” said the captain.

“Ten to one this “Who goes? Stand, or we fire.”

“Flag of truce,” cried Silver.

The captain was in the porch, protected from a treacherous shot should any be intended. He turned and spoke to us: “Doctor’s watch on the lookout. Dr. Livesey, take the north side; Jim, the east; Gray, west. The watch below, all hands to load muskets. Lively, men.” And then he turned again to the mutineers.

“And what do you want with your flag of truce?” he cried.

This time the other man replied.

“Cap’n Silver, sir, to come on board and make terms,” he shouted.

“Cap’n Silver! Don’t know him. Who’s he?” cried the captain. And we could hear him adding to himself: “Cap’n, is it?”

Long John answered for himself.

“Me, sir. These poor lads have chosen me cap’n, after your desertion, sir. We’re willing to submit, if we can come to terms, and no bones about it. All I ask is your word, Cap’n Smollett, to let me safe and sound out of this here stockade, and one minute to get out o’ shot before a gun is fired.”

“I have not the slightest desire to talk with you,” said Captain Smollett.

“If you wish to talk to me, you can come, that’s all. If there’s any treachery, the Lord help you.”

“A word from you’s enough,” shouted Long John, cheerily. He advanced to the stockade, threw over his crutch, got a leg up, and with great vigor and skill climbed the fence and dropped safely to the other side.

I confess I was too much taken up with what was going on to be of the slightest use as sentry. I had already deserted my position and crept up behind the captain, who had now seated himself on the threshold.

Silver had terrible hard work getting up the knoll. At last he arrived before the captain, whom he saluted in the handsomest style. He was dressed in his best: an immense blue coat, thick with brass buttons, hung to his knees, and a fine laced hat was set on the back of his head.

“You had better sit down,” said the captain.

“You ain’t a-going to let me inside, cap’n?” complained Silver.

“It’s a cold morning, sir.”

“Why, Silver,” said the captain, “if you were an honest man, you’d be sitting in your galley. It’s your own doing. You’re either my ship’s cook or Cap’n Silver, a common pirate!”

“Well, cap’n,” returned the sea cook, sitting down on the sand, “you’ll have to give me a hand up again, that’s all. Ah, there’s Jim! Why, there you all are together like a happy family.”

“If you have anything to say, my man, better say it,” said the captain.

“Right, Cap’n Smollett,” replied Silver.

“Duty is duty. Well, now, that was a good fight of yours last night.

Some of you are pretty handy with a handspike end. And I’ll not deny but what some of my people was afraid. Maybe I was afraid myself; maybe that’s HANDSPIKE why I’m here for terms. But you mark me, as a lever. cap’n, it won’t work twice! We’ll do sentry, and ease off the rum. Maybe you think we were all drunk. But I was sober, I was only dog tired. If I’d awoke a second sooner I’d ‘a’ caught you at the act. He wasn’t dead when I got to him.”

“Well?” says Captain Smollett, as cool as can be.

All that Silver said was a riddle to him, but you would never have guessed it from his tone. I began to suppose that Ben Gunn had paid the buccaneers a visit while they lay drunk around their fire, and I reckoned with glee that we had only fourteen enemies to deal with.

“Well, here it is,” said Silver.

“We want that trea-

sure, and we’ll have it! You would just as soon save your lives, I reckon. We want your chart. I never meant you harm.”

“That won’t do with me,” interrupted the captain.

“We know exactly what you meant to do, and we don’t care. For now, you can’t do it.” And the captain proceeded to fill a pipe.

Silver filled his pipe and lighted it, and the two men sat silently smoking for quite awhile, looking each other in the face.

“You give us the chart,” resumed Silver, “and stop shooting poor seamen, and bashing their heads in while asleep. You do that, and we’ll offer you a choice. Either you come aboard with us once the treasure’s shipped, and I’ll give you my word of honor to put you somewhere safe ashore. Or, if that ain’t to your fancy, some of my hands having old scores to settle on account of mistreatment, you can stay here. We’ll divide supplies with you, man for man, and I’ll send the first ship I sight to pick you up. I hope” – raising his voice – “that all hands in this here blockhouse will overhear me, for what is spoke to one is spoke to all.”

Captain Smollett rose from his seat, and knocked out the ashes of his pipe.

“Is that all?” he asked.

“Every last word, by thunder!” answered John.

“Refuse that, and you’ve seen the last of me but musket balls.”

“Now hear me,” said the captain.

“If you come up one by one, unarmed, I’ll clap you all in irons and take you home to a fair trial in England. If you grave. won’t, I’ll see you all to Davy Jones . You can’t find the treasure. You can’t fight us – Gray, there, got away from five of you. Your ship’s in irons , you are on a lee shore. Those are the last good words you’ll get from me, for I’ll put a bullet in your back when next I IN IRONS meet you. Now get going.” maneuver.

Silver’s eyes filled with wrath. He shook the fire out of his pipe.

“Give me a hand up!” he cried.

“Not I,” returned the captain.

“Who’ll give me a hand up?” he roared.

Not a man among us moved. Growling curses, he crawled along the sand till he got hold of the porch and could hoist himself upon his crutch. Then he spat into “give me a hand up!” he cried. the spring.

“There!” he cried, “that’s what I think of ye. Before an hour’s out, I’ll knock in your old blockhouse. Them that die’ll be the lucky ones.” And with an oath he stumbled off, plowed down the sand, was helped across the stockade, after four or five failures, by the man with the flag of truce, and disappeared among the trees.

Chapter 21 - The Attack

As soon as Silver disappeared, the captain turned towards the interior of the house, and found not a man at his post but Gray. It was the “Quarters!” he roared. And then, as we all slunk back to our places, “Gray,” he said, “You’ve stood by your duty like a seaman. Mr. Trelawney, I’m surprised at you, sir.

The doctor’s watch returned to their loopholes, and the rest were busy loading the spare muskets, and every one with a red face.

The captain looked on in silence. Then he spoke.

“Lads,” said he, “I’ve given Silver a broadside, and pitched it red-hot on purpose. Before the hour’s out, he will attack. We’re outnumbered, but we fight in shelter. I’ve no doubt that we can defeat them, if you choose.” Then he went the rounds and saw, as he said, that all was clear.

On the two short sides of the house, east and west, there were two loopholes; on the side where the porch was, two again; and on the north side, five. There were twenty muskets for the seven of us; the firewood had been built into four piles, one about the middle of each side, and on each of these piles some ammunition and four loaded muskets were laid ready. In the middle, the cutlasses lay ranged.

“Toss out the fire,” said the captain.

“We mustn’t have smoke in our eyes. Quickly, lads. Hunter, serve a round of brandy to all hands.”

“Doctor, you take the door,” continued the captain.

“Don’t expose yourself. Keep within, and fire through the porch. Hunter, take the east side. Joyce, stand by the west.

Mr. Trelawney and Gray will take the long side with five loopholes. It’s there the danger is. If they can fire in on us through our own ports, things would begin to look dirty. Hawkins, we’ll stand by to load.”

The sun climbed above the trees around us, fell on the clearing, and the vapors disappeared. Soon the sand was baking and the resin melting in the logs of the blockhouse. We stood at our posts in a fever of heat and anxiety.

An hour passed.

“Hang them!” said the captain.

We were on the alert, straining our ears and eyes – the musketeers with their pieces balanced in their hands, the captain out in the middle of the blockhouse, with a frown on his face.

Suddenly Joyce whipped up his musket and fired. The report had scarcely died away before it was repeated outside in a scattering volley from every side of the enclosure. Several bullets struck the log-house, but none entered, and as the smoke cleared away, the stockade and the woods around it looked quiet and empty.

Suddenly, with a loud cheer, a little cloud of pirates leaped from the woods on the north side, and ran straight on the stockade. At the same moment, fire opened from the woods. A rifle ball sang through the doorway and knocked the doctor’s musket into bits.

The boarders swarmed over the fence like monkeys. Squire and Gray fired again and again. Three men fell, one into the enclosure, two back on the outside. Of these, one was more frightened than hurt, for he was on his feet again and instantly disappeared among the trees.

Four were inside our defenses, while from the shelter of the woods seven or eight men kept firing on the log-house.

The four inside came for the building, shouting as they ran, and the men among the trees shouted back to encourage them. Several shots were fired, but not one took effect. In a moment, the four pirates had swarmed up the mound and were upon us.

Job Anderson appeared at the middle loophole.

“At ‘em, all hands!” he roared, in a voice of thunder. Another pirate grasped Hunter’s musket by the muzzle, wrenched it from his hands, plucked it through the loophole, and with one stunning blow, laid the poor fellow senseless on the the boarders swarmed over the fence like monkeys. floor. Meanwhile a third appeared suddenly in the doorway, and fell with his cutlass on the doctor.

The log-house was full of smoke; cries and confusion, the flashes and reports of pistol shots, and one loud groan rang in my ears.

“Out, lads, out, and fight ‘em in the open! Cutlasses!” cried the captain.

I snatched a cutlass from the pile, and dashed out into the sunlight. The doctor was pursuing his assailant down the hill, and just as my eyes fell upon him, beat down his guard, and sent him sprawling, with a great slash across the face.

“Round the house, lads! Round the house!” cried the captain. And even in the hurly-burly, I perceived a change in his voice.

Mechanically, I obeyed, and with my cutlass raised, ran round the corner of the house. Next moment I was face to face with Anderson. He roared, and his cutlass went up above his head, flashing in the sunlight. I leaped to one side and rolled headlong down the slope.

Gray, following close behind me, cut down the boatswain before he had time to recover from his last blow. Another had been shot at a loophole in the act of firing into the house, and now lay in agony, the pistol still smoking in his hand. A third, as I had seen, the doctor had disposed of at a blow. Of the four who scaled the palisade, one only remained unaccounted for. And he, leaving his cutlass on the field, was now clambering out again with the fear of death on him. In three seconds nothing remained of the attacking party but the five who had fallen.

The doctor and Gray and I ran full speed for shelter. At any moment the fire might recommence.

The house was somewhat cleared of smoke, and we saw the price we had paid for victory. Hunter lay beside his loophole, stunned. Joyce lay shot through the head, never to move again. In the center, the squire was supporting the captain, one as pale as the other.

“The captain’s wounded,” said Mr. Trelawney.

“Have they run?” asked Captain Smollett.

“All that could,” returned the doctor.

“But there’s five that will never run again.”

“Five!” cried the captain.

“That’s better. Five against three leaves us four to nine. That’s better odds than we had at starting.”

Part V

Chapter 22 - How I Began My Sea Adventure

There was no return of the mutineers. They had had enough, and we had time to overhaul the Of the eight men who had fallen in the action, only three still breathed – one of the pirates shot at the loophole, Hunter, and Captain Smollett. The mutineer died under the doctor’s knife, and Hunter never recovered consciousness in As for the captain, his wounds were serious, but not dangerous. Job Anderson’s ball had broken his shoulder blade and touched the lung, but not badly. The second had torn some muscles in the calf. He was sure to recover, the doctor said, but for weeks he must not walk or move his arm, nor speak when

he could help it.

After dinner the squire and the doctor sat by the captain's side a while in consultation. A little past noon, the doctor took up his hat and pistols, put on a cutlass, put the chart in his pocket, and with a musket over his shoulder, crossed the palisade on the north side, and set off briskly through the trees.

"Is Dr. Livesey mad?" Gray asked me.

"He's about the last of this crew for that," I said.

"If I am right, he's going to see Ben Gunn."

I was right, as appeared later. But in the meantime, the house being stifling hot, I had another thought. I began to envy the doctor, walking in the cool shadow of the woods, while I sat grilling, with so much blood about me and so many poor dead bodies lying all around. I took a disgust of the place that was almost as strong as fear.

All the time I was washing out the blockhouse, this disgust and envy kept growing stronger, till I took the first step toward my escape, and filled both pockets of my coat with biscuits. I also took two pistols, and as I already had a powder horn and bullets, I felt myself well-supplied with arms. As for the scheme I had in my head, it was not a bad one in itself. I was to go down the sandy spit and look for Benn Gunn's boat. I planned to slip out when nobody was watching. It was wrong, but I was only a boy, and I had made my mind up. As the squire and Gray were busy helping the captain with his bandages, I made a bolt for it into the trees, and before my absence was observed I was out of cry of my companions.

This was my second folly, far worse than the first, as I left but two sound men to guard the house. But like the first, it was a help towards saving all of us.

I headed straight for the east coast of the island, for I was determined to avoid all chance of observation from the anchorage. It was already late in the afternoon, although still warm and sunny. As I continued through the woods I could hear not only the thunder of the surf, but a tossing and grinding of boughs which showed me the sea breeze had set in higher than usual. Soon I came forth into the open and saw the sea lying blue and sunny to the horizon, and the surf tumbling its foam along the beach.

I walked along the surf till, thinking I was far enough to the south, I took cover of some bushes, and crept warily to the ridge of the spit.

Behind me was the sea, in front, the anchorage, which lay still and leaden as when first we entered it. The Hispaniola, in that unbroken mirror, was exactly portrayed from the top of the mast to the waterline, the Jolly Roger hanging from her peak.

Alongside lay one of the gigs, with Silver in the rear. A couple of men were leaning over the stern bulwarks, one of them with a red cap – the very rogue that I had seen hours ago straddling the palisade. BULWARKS Apparently they were talking and laughing, woodwork along though at that distance I could hear no word of above the what was said. All at once, there began an unearthly screaming, which at first startled me, though I soon remembered the voice of Captain Flint. I even thought I could make out the bird by her bright plumage as she perched upon her master's wrist.

Soon the boat shoved off and the man with the red cap and his comrade went below.

The sun had gone down behind the Spyglass, and it grew dark in earnest. I must lose no time if I were to find the boat that evening.

The white rock was still further down the spit, and it took me a while to get up to it, crawling among the scrub. Night had almost come when I laid my hand on its rough sides. Below it, hidden by banks and thick underwood about knee-deep, was a little tent of goat skins.

I dropped into the hollow, lifted the side of the tent, and there was Ben Gunn's boat – a lopsided framework of wood, and stretched upon that a covering of goat skin, with the hair inside. It was extremely small, even for me. Still, it was a skins. I decided to slip out under cover of night, cut the Hispaniola loose, and let her drift ashore. I had made up my mind that the mutineers planned to pull anchor and get away to sea. Now that I had seen how they left their watchmen without a boat, I thought I could prevent their escape with little risk.

I sat down to wait for darkness and made a hearty meal of biscuit. It was a night out of ten thousands for my i dropped into the hollow, lifted the side of the tent, and purpose. The fog had buried all heaven. As the last rays of daylight disappeared, absolute blackness settled down on Treasure Island. And when, at last, I shoved the boat out of the hollow, there were but two points visible on the whole anchorage.

One was the great fire on shore, by which the defeated pirates lay carousing. The other, a mere blur of light, was a reflection on the fog of the light flowing from the stern window of the ship. Wading a little way into the water, I set my coracle on the surface.

Chapter 23 - The Ebb-Tide Runs

The coracle was a very safe boat for a person my size, but she was the most lopsided craft to neuver she was best at. Even Ben Gunn admitted that she At first, she turned in every direction but the one I chose. Most of the time we were broadside on, but by good fortune, the tide swept me down to the Hispaniola . First she loomed before me like a blot of something blacker than darkness. Then her spars and hull began to take shape, and the next moment, as it seemed, I was alongside of her hawser and had laid hold.

The hawser was as taut as a bowstring, and the current so strong she pulled on her anchor. All round the hull, the current the anchor. bubbled like a little mountain stream. One cut with my knife, and the ship would go humming down the tide.

So far so good, but I remembered that a taut hawser, suddenly cut, is as dangerous as a kicking horse. Ten to one, if I were so foolhardy as to cut the Hispaniola from her anchor, the coracle would be knocked clean out of the water. If fortune had not again favored me, I should have had to abandon my plan. But a puff of wind caught the Hispaniola and forced her up into the current. To my great joy, I felt the hawser slacken in my grasp, and the hand by which I held it dip for a second under water.

With that, I took out my knife, opened it with my teeth, and cut one strand after another, till the vessel swung only by two. Then I lay quiet, waiting to sever these last when the strain should be once more lightened by a wind.

All this time I had heard loud voices from the cabin. One I recognized as that of Israel Hands. The other was, of course, my friend of the red nightcap. Both men were plainly drunk. One of them, with a cry, opened the stern window and threw out an empty bottle. But they were not only drunk, they were furiously angry. Oaths flew like hailstones, but their quarrel passed off for awhile, until the next crisis came, and the cycle continued.

On shore, I could see the glow of the great camp fire burning through the trees. Someone was singing a sailor's song, with a droop and a quaver at the end of every verse.

At last the breeze came. I felt the hawser slacken once more, and with some effort, I cut the last fibers through.

The breeze had little effect on the coracle, and I was almost instantly swept against the bows of the Hispaniola. At the same time, the schooner began to spin slowly, end for end, in the current.

I expected to be swamped, and since I found I could not push the coracle directly off, I shoved straight astern. At length I was clear of my dangerous neighbor, and just as I gave the last push, my hands came across a cord that was trailing overboard across the stern bulwarks. Instantly I grabbed it.

It was at first mere instinct, but once I had it in my hands, I determined I should have one look through the cabin window.

I pulled myself up, at infinite risk, and thus commanded a slice of the interior of the cabin.

By this time the schooner and her consort were gliding swiftly through the water. Indeed, we were already level with the campfire. The ship was talking, as sailors say, loudly, and until I got my eye above the windowsill I could not comprehend why the watchmen had taken no alarm. One glance was sufficient. Hands and his companion were locked together in deadly wrestle, each with a hand on the other's throat.

Suddenly I was surprised by a lurch of the coracle. She seemed to change her course, and her speed had strangely increased. The Hispaniola herself, in whose wake I was being whirled along, seemed to stagger in her course. As I looked longer, I made sure she also was wheeling southward.

I glanced over my shoulder, and my heart jumped hands and his companion were locked together in a deadly wrestle, each with a hand on the other's throat. against my ribs. There, right behind me, was the glow of the campfire. The current had turned at right angles, sweeping along with it the tall schooner and the little coracle. Ever quickening, it went spinning for the open sea.

Suddenly the schooner gave a violent lurch, and a shout came from on board. I could hear feet pounding on the companion ladder, and I knew that the two drunkards had at last awakened to a sense of their disaster.

I lay down flat in the bottom of my boat, and offered my spirit to its Maker. At the end of the straits, I was sure we must fall into raging breakers, where all my troubles would be ended.

So I must have lain for hours, continually beaten to and fro, always expecting death at the next plunge. Gradually weariness fell upon me, even in the midst of my terrors, until sleep at last overcame me, and in my sea-tossed coracle I dreamed of the old "Admiral Benbow."

Chapter 24 - The Cruise of the Coracle

It was broad day when I awoke and found myself tossing at the southwest end of Treasure Island. The sun was still hidden behind the Spyglass, which on this side descended almost to the sea in formidable cliffs. I was scarce a quarter of a mile to seaward, and it was my first That notion was soon abandoned. Among the fallen rocks the breakers spouted and heavy spray flew.

I saw myself, if I ventured nearer, dashed to death upon the rough shore, or spending my strength in vain to scale the crags.

In the meantime I had a better chance before me. To the north, there comes another cape – Cape of the Woods, as it was marked upon the chart – buried in tall pines, which descended to the margin of the sea. I remembered what Silver had said about the current that sets northward along the whole west coast of Treasure Island, and seeing from my position that I was already under its influence, I decided to reserve my strength for an attempt to land upon the kindlier-looking Cape of the Woods.

It is surprising how easily and securely my little boat could ride. Often, as I still lay at the bottom, and kept no more than an eye above the gunwale, I would see a big blue summit heaving above me, and the coracle would but bounce a little, dance as if on springs, and subside on the other side into the trough as lightly as a bird.

I began to grow bold, and sat up to try my skill paddling. But even a small change in position of the weight will produce violent changes in the behavior of a coracle. And I had hardly moved before the boat, giving up her gentle dancing movement, ran straight down a slope of water so steep that it made me giddy, and struck her nose deep into the next wave.

I was drenched and terrified, and fell instantly back into my old position, whereupon the coracle seemed to find her head again. I bailed her out with my sea cap, then set myself to study how it was she managed to slip so quietly through the rollers.

I found each wave, instead of the big, smooth glossy mountain it looks from shore, or from a vessel's deck, was for all the world like any range of hills on dry land, full of peaks and smooth places and valleys. The coracle, left to herself, turning from side to side, made her way through these lower parts and avoided the steep slopes and toppling summits of the wave.

I lay on my elbows and every now and again in the smooth places put the paddle over the side and gave her a shove or two toward land.

It was very tiring and slow work, yet I did make progress. It was high time, for I now began to be tortured with thirst. The glow of the sun from above, its thousand-fold reflection from the waves, the seawater I was drenched and terrified. that fell and dried upon me, caking my very lips with salt, combined to make my throat burn and my brain ache. The

sight of the trees so near at hand had almost made me sick with longing, but the current had soon carried me past the point of the Cape and as the next reach of sea opened out, I beheld a sight that changed the nature of my thoughts.

Right in front of me, I beheld the Hispaniola under sail. I was sure that I should be taken, but I was so distressed for want of water that I scarce knew whether to be glad or sorry. She was under her mainsail and two jibs, and the beautiful white canvas shone in the sun like silver. When I first sighted her, all her sails were drawing, and she was laying a course about northwest.

Meanwhile, the schooner gradually fell off and filled again upon another tack, sailed swiftly for a minute or so, and brought up once more dead in the wind's eye. To and fro, up and down, the direction of and at each repetition ended as she had the wind. begun, with idly flapping canvas. No one was steering. Where were the men? Either they were dead drunk, or had deserted her. If I could get on board, I might return the vessel to her captain.

The current was bearing coracle and schooner southward at an equal rate. As for the latter's sailing, it was so wild and intermittent, that she certainly gained nothing. If only I dared to sit up and paddle, I was sure that I could overhaul her. And the thought of the drinking water beside the fore companion doubled my courage.

I set myself to paddle. Once I had to stop and bail, but gradually I got into the way of the thing, and guided my coracle among the waves, with only now and then a dash of foam in my face.

I was now gaining rapidly on the schooner. And still no soul appeared upon her decks. I supposed she was deserted. If not, the men were lying drunk below, where I might batten them down, and do what I chose with the ship.

For some time she had been doing the worst thing possible for me. She headed nearly due south, yawing, of course, all the time, and continued to run away from me with the speed of the current. But now, at last, I had my chance. The breeze fell very low, and the current gradually turned her. The Hispaniola revolved slowly round her center, and at last presented me her stern, with the cabin window still open, and the lamp over the table still burning. The mainsail drooped like a banner. She was still, but for the current.

I was not a hundred yards from her when the wind came again in a clap. She filled on the port tack, and was off again, stooping and skimming like a swallow.

My first impulse was one of despair, but my second was towards joy. Round she came. I could see the waves boiling white under her. Immensely tall she looked from my low station. And then I had scarce time to think and to act to save myself. I was on the summit of one swell when the schooner came stooping over. The bowsprit was over my head. I sprang to my feet, and leaped, stamping the coracle under water. With one hand I caught the jib-boom, and as I clung there the jib-sail. panting, a dull blow told me that the schooner had struck the coracle, and that I was left without retreat on the Hispaniola.

Chapter 25 - I Strike the Jolly Roger

I had scarce gained a position on the bowsprit, when the flying jib flapped and filled

on the other tack, nearly tossing me off into the sea. Now I lost no time. I crawled back along the bowsprit, and tum-The mainsail concealed from me part of the afterdeck. Not a soul was to be seen. SCUPPERS

Drain holes along A broken bottle tumbled to and fro like a the bulwarks that aloow water to run off the decks.

Suddenly the Hispaniola came right into the wind. The jibs behind me cracked, the rudder slammed, the whole ship gave a sickening heave and shudder, and at the same moment the main boom swung inboard, groaning in the blocks, and showed me the afterdeck.

There were the two watchmen: red-cap was on his back, as stiff as a handspike, with his arms stretched out like those of a crucifix. Israel Hands was propped against the bulwark, his chin on his chest, his hands lying open, his face as white as a tallow candle.

The ship kept bucking like a vicious horse, the sails filling on one tack, then another, till the mast groaned aloud under the strain. At every jump of the schooner, redcap slipped, his face fixed in a ghastly teeth-disclosing grin. Hands seemed to settle down, too, his feet slid farther out and his face become hidden.

I observed around both of them splashes of dark blood, and began to feel sure that they had killed each other in their drunken wrath.

In a calm moment, when the ship was still, Israel Hands turned partly around, with a low moan. The moan, which told of pain, and the way in which his jaw hung open, went right to my heart. But when I remembered the talk I had overheard from the apple barrel, all pity left me.

I walked aft until I reached the mainmast.

"Come aboard, Mr. Hands," I said ironically.

He rolled his eyes round heavily, but he was too far gone. He said only one word, "Brandy."

It occurred to me there was no time to lose, and I slipped down the stairs to the cabin.

It was a scene of confusion. All the locked places had been broken open in quest of the chart. Dozens of empty bottles clinked together in corners to the rolling of the ship. All the barrels were empty, and a surprising number of bottles had been drunk. Since the mutiny began, not a man of them could have been sober.

I found a bottle with some brandy left for Hands. For myself I routed out some biscuit, pickled fruits, raisins and a piece of cheese. On deck, I went forward to the water breaker, and had a good, deep drink of water before giving Hands the brandy.

He took a big drink from the bottle.

I sat down in a corner and began to eat.

"I've come aboard to take possession of this ship, Mr. Hands. Regard me as your captain."

"i can't have these colors, mr. hands," i said.

He looked at me sourly, but said nothing. Some of the color had come back into his cheeks, though he still looked very sick.

"I can't have these colors, Mr. Hands," I said. I ran to the color lines, handed down their cursed black flag, and chucked it overboard.

"God save the king!" said I, waving my cap.

He watched me slyly, his chin on his breast.

"I reckon, Captain Hawkins," he said at last, "you'll want to get ashore. Suppose we talks."

"This man," he began, nodding feebly at the corpse – "this man and me got the canvas on her, meaning for to sail her back. Who's to sail this, now? Without I gives you a hint, you ain't that man. Now, look here, you gives me food and drink, and an old scarf to tie my wound up, and I'll tell you how to sail her."

"I'm not going back to Captain Kidd's anchorage. I mean to get to North Inlet," I said.

"I can see, can't I?" he cried.

"I've tried my fling, and I've lost. North Inlet? Why, I haven't no choice! I'd help you sail her up to Execution Dock, by thunder!"

We struck our bargain. In three minutes I had the Hispaniola sailing easily before the wind along the coast of Treasure Island, with good hopes of turning the northern point before noon, and beating down again as far as North Inlet before high water, when we might beach her safely. Then I lashed the tiller and went below to my own chest, where I got a silk handkerchief of my mother's. With my aid, Hands bound up the wound in his thigh, and after he had a swallow or two more of brandy, he sat straighter, spoke clearer, and looked in every way another man.

We skimmed before the breeze like a bird, the coast flashing by, and the view changing every minute. Soon we turned the corner of the rocky hill that ends the island on the north.

I was elated with my new command, and my conscience, which had smitten me hard for my desertion, was quieted by the great conquest I had made. My contentment was nearly complete except for the eyes of the coxswain as they followed me about the deck, and the odd smile on his face. It was a smile of pain and weakness, but there was also the shadow of treachery.

Chapter 26 - Israel Hands

The wind now hauled into the west. We could run easy from the northeast corner of the island to the mouth of the North Inlet. Only, as we had no anchor, and dared not beach her till the tide had flowed farther, time hung on our hands. We both sat in silence over another meal.

"Cap'n," said he, at length, with that same un-

comfortable smile, "Here's old O'Brien. Suppose you was to heave him overboard. I

ain't particular as a rule, and I don't take no blame for killing him, but I don't reckon him ornamental, now, do you?"

"I'm not strong enough, and I don't like the job, and there he lies for me," said I.

"This here's an unlucky ship, Jim," he went on.

"There's a power of men been killed in this Hispaniola – a

sight o' poor men dead and gone since you and me took ship. Well, now, I'm no scholar, and you're a lad as can read and figure. Do you take it as a dead man is dead for good, or does he come alive again?"

"You can kill the body, but not the spirit. You must know that already," I replied.

"O'Brien is in another world, and may be watching us."

"Ah!" says he.

"Well – appears as if killing par-

ties was a waste of time. Howsoever, spirits don't reckon for much, by what I've seen. I'll chance it with the spirits, Jim. And now, I'll take it kind if you'd get me a – well, you get me a bottle of wine. This here brandy's too strong."

Now, as for the notion of his preferring wine to brandy, I entirely disbelieved it. The whole story was a pretext. He wanted me to leave the deck, but with what purpose I could in no way imagine. His eyes kept wandering up and down, with a flitting glance upon the dead O'Brien. All the time he kept smiling in the most guilty, embarrassed manner, so that a child could have told that he was bent on deception. However, I saw my advantage, and that with a fellow so stupid I could easily conceal my suspicions.

"Some wine?" said I.

"White or red?"

"Well, I reckon it's about the blessed same to me," he replied, "so it's strong, and plenty of it."

"All right," I answered.

"I'll bring you port, Mr.

Hands. But I'll have to dig for it."

I scuttled down the companion with all the noise I could, slipped off my shoes, ran quietly along the gallery, mounted the forecastle ladder, and popped my head out. I knew he would not expect to see me there.

He had risen to his hands and knees, and, though his leg obviously hurt him sharply when he moved, he pulled himself across the deck at a good rate. In half a minute he had reached a long knife, discolored to the hilt with blood. He tried the point upon his hand, and then concealing it in his jacket, trundled back again into his old place against the bulwark.

This was all I needed to know. Israel could move about, he was armed, and I was meant to be the victim. Yet I felt sure that I could trust him in one point, and that was in the disposition of the schooner. We both desired to have her stranded in a sheltered place, so that

when the time came, she could be got off again with as little labor and danger as might be. Until that was done my life would certainly be spared.

While I was turning the business over in my mind, I had stolen back to the cabin, slipped into my shoes, laid my hand on a bottle of wine, and made my reappearance on the deck.

Hands lay as I had left him, all fallen together, and with his eyelids lowered, as though he were too weak to bear the light. He looked, however, at my coming, knocked the neck off the bottle, and took a good swig. He lay quiet for a little, and then begged for tobacco.

“Cut me some,” says he.

“I haven’t no knife. It’ll be the last, lad, for I’m for my long home.”

“Well,” said I, “I’ll cut you some tobacco, but if I was you, I would go to my prayers.”

“Why?” said he.

“Tell me why.”

“Why?” I cried.

“You’ve broken your trust. You’ve lived in sin and lies and blood. There’s a man you killed lying at your feet. And you ask me why! For God’s mercy, that’s why.”

I spoke with a little heat, thinking of the bloody dirk he had hidden in his pocket. He took a great draught of the wine, and spoke with the most unusual solemnity.

“For thirty years,” he said, “I’ve sailed the seas, and seen good and bad, fair weather and foul, provisions running out, knives going, and what not. Well, I tell you, I never seen good come o’ goodness yet. Him as strikes first is my fancy. Dead men don’t bite. Them’s my views

– amen. And now, look here,” he added, changing his tone, “we’ve had about enough of foolery. The tide’s made good by now. You take orders, Cap’n Hawkins, and we’ll be done with it.”

We had scarce two miles to run, but the navigation was delicate. The entrance to this anchorage was narrow and shoal, so that the schooner must be nicely handled to be got in. Hands was an excellent pilot, for we dodged in with a neatness that was a pleasure to behold.

The shores of North Inlet were as thickly wooded as those of southern anchorage, but the space was longer and narrower, and more like what in truth it was, the estuary of a river.

“Now,” said Hands, “look there. There’s a place for to beach a ship in. Fine flat sand.”

“And once beached,” I inquired, “how shall we get her off again?”

“You take a line ashore there on the other side at low water: take a turn about one of them gib pines, bring it back, take a turn around the capstan, and lie-to for the tide. Come high water, all hands pull upon the line, and off she comes as sweet as nature. And now, boy, stand by.”

He issued his commands, which I breathlessly obeyed. I put the helm hard up, and

the Hispaniola swung around rapidly, and ran stem on for the low wooded shore.

The excitement of these last maneuvers had interfered with the watch I had kept on the coxswain. I had quite forgot the peril hung over my head, and stood craning over the starboard bulwarks and watching the ripples spreading wide before the bows. Perhaps I heard a creak, or saw his shadow moving. Perhaps it was an instinct like a cat's. But sure enough, when I looked round, there was Hands, already halfway towards me, with the dirk in his right hand.

We must both have cried out when our eyes met, but his was a roar of fury like a charging bull's. I leaped sideways. As I did so, I let go of the tiller, which sprang sharp to seaward. This saved my life, for it struck Hands and stopped him.

Before he could recover, I was out of the corner where he had me trapped. Just forward of the mainmast I stopped, drew a pistol, took a cool aim at him, and drew the trigger. The hammer fell, but there followed neither flash nor sound; the priming was useless with water.

Wounded as he was, it was wonderful how fast he could move. I had no time to try my other pistol. I was sure it would be useless. I must now simply retreat before him, or he would hold me boxed into the bows.

Seeing that I meant to dodge, he also paused, and a moment or two passed in feints on his part, and corresponding movements upon mine. I had often played such a game at home, but never before with such a wildly beating heart as now. Still, I thought I could hold my own against a seaman with a wounded thigh.

Suddenly the Hispaniola staggered into the sand, and then canted over to the port side, till the deck stood at an angle of forty-five degrees.

Both of us rolled into the scuppers. The dead redcap, with his arms spread, tumbled after us. I was the first afoot again, for Hands had rolled into the dead body. I had to find some new way of escape that instant, for my foe was almost touching me. Quick as thought, I sprang into the shrouds, rattled up hand over hand, and did not breathe till I was seated on the crosstrees.

I had been saved by being prompt. The dirk had struck not half a foot below me, and there stood Israel Hands with his mouth open, a perfect statue of disappointment.

I lost no time in changing the priming of my pistol. Then, having one ready for service, I proceeded to prepare the other as well.

Hands began to see the dice going against him. He hauled himself heavily into the shrouds, and, with the dirk in his teeth, began painfully to mount. He was a third of the way up by the time I had readied my pistols.

"One more step, Mr. Hands," said I, "and I'll blow your brains out! Dead men don't bite, you know," I said with a chuckle.

He stopped instantly. I could see by his face that he was trying to think, and the process was so slow and labowith a choked cry, the coxswain plunged headfirst into the water. rious that I laughed aloud. His face wore an expression of extreme perplexity. In order

to speak he had to take the dagger from his mouth, but, in all else, he remained unmoved.

“Jim,” says he, “I’d have had you but for that there lurch: but I don’t have no luck. I reckon I’ll have to strike, which comes hard for a master mariner to a ship’s youngster like you, Jim.”

I was drinking in his words, as conceited as a cock upon a wall, when back went his right hand over his shoulder. Something sang like an arrow through the air. I felt a blow and then a sharp pang, and there I was pinned by the shoulder to the mast. In the pain and surprise of the moment, and I am sure it was without a conscious aim, both pistols went off and escaped out of my hands. They did not fall alone. With a choked cry, the coxswain plunged headfirst into the water.

Chapter 27 - Pieces of Eight

Owing to the lean of the vessel, the masts hung far out over the water, and I had nothing below me but the surface of the bay. Hands rose once to the surface in a lather of foam and blood, and then sank again for good. As the water settled, I could see him lying on the clean sand in the shadow of the vessel.

I began to feel faint and terrified. Hot blood was running over my back and chest. The dirk seemed to burn like a hot iron, yet it was not so much these real sufferings that distressed me, it was the horror I had of falling into that green water near the body of the coxswain.

It was my first thought to pull out the dirk, but either it stuck too hard or my nerve failed me. Instead, I gave a violent shudder that was enough to tear away the piece of skin held by the knife. The blood ran down faster, but now I was only tacked to the mast by my coat and shirt.

These I broke through with a sudden jerk, and then regained the deck. I went below and did what I could for my wound. It pained me a good deal, and bled freely, but it was neither deep nor dangerous, nor did it greatly gall me when I used my arm. Then I looked around me, and as the ship was now my own, I began to think of clearing its last passenger – O’Brien.

He had pitched against the bulwarks, where he lay like some horrible sort of puppet. I took him by the waist as if he had been a sack of bran, and, with one good heave, tumbled him overboard. He went in with a sounding plunge. The red cap came off and floated on the surface, and as soon as the splash subsided, I could see him and Israel lying side by side.

I began to see a danger to the ship. The jibs I speedily doused and brought to the deck, but the mainsail was a harder matter. When the schooner canted over, the boom had swung outboard and the cap of it and a foot or two of sail hung under water. The strain was so heavy that I feared to meddle. At last, I cut the halyards. The peak dropped instantly, and a great belly of canvas floated on the water. For the rest, the Hispaniola must trust to luck, like myself.

I scrambled forward and looked over. It seemed shallow enough, and I let myself drop softly overboard. The water scarcely reached my waist. I waded ashore in great spirits,

about the same time the sun went fairly down.

At last, I was off the sea, nor had I returned empty-handed. There lay the schooner, clear from buccaneers and ready for our own men. I couldn't wait to get to the stockade and boast of my achievements. I hoped that even Captain Smollett would confess I had not lost my time.

So thinking, I headed for the blockhouse. I remembered that the rivers which drain into Captain Kidd's anchorage ran from the two-peaked hill on my left. I bent my course in that direction.

This brought me near to where I had encountered Ben Gunn, and I walked, keeping an eye on every side. I became aware of a wavering glow, where, I judged, the man of the island was cooking his supper before a roaring fire. I wondered that he should show himself so careless. For if I could see this radiance, might it not reach the eyes of Silver?

Suddenly a brightness fell about me. I looked up, and a pale glimmer of moonbeams had alighted on the summit of the Spyglass.

With the moon to help me, I continued rapidly, and impatiently drew near the stockade. As I began to thread the grove before it, I went a trifle warily. It would have been a poor end to get shot by my own party by mistake.

At last I came down upon the borders of the clearing. The western end was already steeped in moonshine. The blockhouse itself still lay in a black shadow, checkered with silvery streaks of light. On the other side of the house an immense fire had burned itself into embers. There was not a soul stirring, nor a sound.

I stopped in wonder and with a bit of terror, too. It had not been our way to build great fires. I began to fear with my arms before me, I walked steadily in. That something had gone wrong.

I stole round the eastern end, keeping close in shadow, and at a convenient place, where the darkness was thickest, crossed the palisade.

I got upon my hands and knees, and crawled towards the corner of the house. As I drew nearer, my heart was suddenly lightened by the sound of my friends snoring together so loud and peaceful in their sleep.

In the meantime, they kept an infamous bad watch. If it had been Silver and his lads now creeping in on them, not a soul would have seen daybreak. Again I blamed myself for leaving them with so few to mount guard.

By this time I had got to the door and stood up. All was dark within. As for sounds, there was the steady drone of the snorers, and a small occasional noise, a pecking that I could in no way account for. With my arms before me, I walked steadily in. I should lie down in my own place, I thought with a silent chuckle, and enjoy their faces when they found me in the morning.

My foot struck something – it was a sleeper's leg. He turned and groaned without waking. And then, all of a sudden, a shrill voice broke forth out of the darkness: "Pieces of eight! Pieces of eight! Pieces of eight!"

Silver's green parrot, Captain Flint! It was she whom I had heard pecking at a piece of bark, and it was she who thus announced my arrival.

I had no time to recover. The sleepers awoke and sprang up, and with a mighty oath, the voice of Silver cried, "Who goes?"

I turned to run, struck against one person and ran into the arms of a second, who held me tight.

"Bring a torch, Dick," said Silver, when my capture was thus assured.

One of the men left the log house and presently returned with a lighted brand.

Part VI

Chapter 28 - In the Enemy's Camp

The glare of the torch lighting up the interior of the blockhouse revealed the pirates in sign of any prisoner. I could only judge that all had per-

There were six buccaneers, all told. Not another man was left alive. Five of them were on their feet, flushed and swollen, called out of their drunken sleep. The sixth had only risen upon his elbow. He was deadly pale, and the blood-stained bandage round his head told that he had recently been wounded. I remembered the man who had been shot and had run back among the woods in the attack.

"So," said Long John, "here's Jim Hawkins, shiver my timbers! Dropped in, like, eh?" And he sat down across the brandy cask, and began to fill a pipe.

"Give me a light, Dick," said he.

"And so,

Jim, quite a pleasant surprise. I seen you were smart when first I set my eyes on you, but this here gets away from me clean, it does."

I stood there looking Silver in the face, pluckily enough, I hope, to all outward appearance, but with black despair in my heart.

Silver took a whiff or two of his pipe.

"Now, you see, Jim, since you are here," says he, "I'll give you a piece of my mind. I've always liked you for a lad of spirit. I always wanted you to find and take your share. And now, you've got to. Cap'n Smollett's a fine seaman, as I'll own up to any day, but stiff on discipline. 'Duty is duty,' says the captain, and right he is. The doctor himself is gone against you. 'Ungrateful scamp' was what he said. You can't go back to your own lot, for they won't have you. You'll have to join with Cap'n Silver."

So far so good. My friends, then, were still alive, and though I partly believed that they were incensed at me for my desertion, I was more relieved than distressed by what I heard.

"Am I to answer then?" I asked, with a very tremulous voice. Through all this

sneering talk, I was made to feel the threat of death, and my heart beat painfully in my breast.

“None of us won’t hurry you,” said Silver.

“Well,” says I, growing a bit bolder, “if I’m to choose, I have a right to know why you’re here and where my friends are.”

“Batten down your hatches till you’re DOWN YOUR spoke to,” cried Silver. Then, in gracious tones he said: “Yesterday morning, Mr. Hawkins,” said he, “down came Dr. Livesey with a flag of truce. Says he,

‘Cap’n Silver, you’re sold out. Ship’s gone.’ Well, maybe we’d been taking a glass. Leastwise, none of us had looked out. We looked out, and by thunder! the old ship was gone. ‘Well,’ says the doctor, ‘let’s bargain.’ We bargained, him and I, and here we are: stores, brandy, blockhouse, the firewood, and the boat. As for them, they’ve tramped. I don’t know where they are.”

He drew again quietly at his pipe.

“And in case you should take it into that head of yours,” he went on, “that you was included in the treaty, when I asked ‘How many are you?’ ‘Four,’ says he, ‘and one of us is wounded. As for that boy, I don’t know where he is, and I don’t much care.’” “Well,” said I, “I know pretty well what I have to look for. Let the worst come, it’s little I care. I’ve seen too many die since I fell in with you. But there’s a thing or two

I have to tell you,” I said, and by this time I was quite excited.

“Here you are, in a bad way: ship lost, treasure lost, men lost. Your whole business gone to wreck, and if you want to know who did it – it was I! I was in the apple barrel the night we sighted land, and I heard you, John, and you, Dick Johnson, and Hands, who is now at the bottom of the sea, and told every word you said before the hour was out. And as for the schooner, it was I who cut her cable, and it was I that killed the men you had aboard her, and it was I who brought her where you’ll never see her more, not one of you. The laugh’s on my side. I no more fear you than I fear a fly. Kill me, if you please, or spare me. But one thing I’ll say, and no more. If you spare me, bygones are bygones, and when you fellows are in court for piracy, I’ll save you all I can. You choose. Kill me and do yourselves no good, or spare me and keep a witness to save you from the gallows.”

I stopped, out of breath. Not a man moved, but all sat staring at me like sheep. And while they were still staring, I broke out again: “And now, Mr. Silver,” I said, “I believe you’re the best man here, and if things go to the worst, I’ll take it kind of you to let the doctor know the way I took it.”

“I’ll bear it in mind,” said Silver, with an accent so curious that I could not decide whether he were laughing at my request, or had been favorably affected by my courage.

“I’ll put one to that,” cried the old mahogany-faced

seaman – Morgan by name – whom I had seen in Long John’s public house in Bristol.

“It was him that knowed Black Dog.”

“It was this same boy that faked the chart from Billy Bones,” added the sea cook.

“First and last, we’ve split upon Jim Hawkins!”

“Then here goes!” said Morgan with an oath. And he sprang up, drawing his knife.

“Avast there, Tom Morgan!” cried Silver.

“Maybe “take a cutlass, him that dares, and you thought you was cap’n here. I’ll teach you better! Cross me, and you’ll go where many a man’s gone before – to feed the fishes.”

Morgan paused, but a hoarse murmur rose from the others.

“Tom’s right,” said one.

“Did any of you gentlemen want to have it out with me?” roared Silver.

“Him that wants shall get it. I’m ready. Take a cutlass, him that dares, and I’ll see the color of his inside.”

Not a man stirred, not a man answered.

“That’s your sort, is it?” he added, returning his pipe to his mouth.

“Not much worth, you ain’t. I’m captain here because I’m the best man by a sea mile. You won’t fight, as gentlemen o’ fortune should. Then, by thunder, you’ll obey! That boy is more a man than any pair of you.”

There was a long pause after this. I stood straight up against the wall, my heart still going like a sledge hammer, but with a ray of hope now shining in my bosom. Silver leaned back as calm as though he had been in church, yet his eye kept wandering upon his unruly followers. They drew together toward the far end of the blockhouse, whispering. One after another, they would look up, but it was not towards me, it was towards Silver that they turned their eyes.

“Ask you pardon, sir,” said one of the men, “you’re pretty free with some of the rules. We don’t like bullying.

This crew has rights like other crews. By your own rules, we can talk together. I ask your pardon, sir, acknowledging you for to be captain at present. But I claim my right and steps outside for a council.” And with an elaborate salute, this fellow, a yellow-eyed man of five and thirty, stepped coolly out of the house. One after another, the rest followed him, each making a salute as he passed, and left Silver and me alone.

“Now, look here, Jim Hawkins,” Silver said, in a whisper that was barely audible, “you’re near your death, and, what’s worse, of torture. They’re going to throw me off. But, you mark, I stand by you through thick and thin.

I didn’t mean to, no, not till you spoke. But I see you was the right sort. I says to myself: You stand by Hawkins, John, and Hawkins’ll stand by you.”

“You mean all’s lost?” I asked.

“I do!” he answered, “Ship gone, neck gone –

that’s the size of it. Once I looked into that bay and seen no schooner – well, I gave out. As for that lot, mark me, they’re outright fools. I’ll save your life if I can – from them. But,

tit for tat, Jim, you save Long John Silver from swinging.”

I was bewildered. It seemed a hopeless thing he was asking – he, the ringleader throughout.

“What I can do, I’ll do,” I said.

“It’s a bargain!” cried Long John.

“You speak up plucky, and by thunder! I have a chance.”

He hobbled to the torch to light his pipe.

“Understand me, Jim,” he said, returning.

“I’ve a head on my shoulders, I have. I’m on squire’s side now. I know you’ve got that ship safe somewhere. How you done it, I don’t know. I guess Hands and O’Brien turned soft. I know when a game’s up, I do. And I know a lad that’s staunch. Ah, you that’s young – you and me might have done a power of good together!”

He drew some cognac from the cask into a tin can and offered me some. When I had refused, he said: “Well, I’ll take a drain myself, Jim, for there’s trouble on hand. And, talking of trouble, why did that doctor give me the chart, Jim?”

My face expressed wonder so unaffected that he saw the needlessness of further questions.

“There’s something under that, no doubt.” And he took another swallow of the brandy, shaking his head like a man who looks forward to the worst.

Chapter 29 - The Black Spot Again

The council had lasted some time, when one of them re-entered the house and begged for the torch. Silver agreed, leaving us in the dark.

Halfway down the slope, the conspirators were collected in a group. One held the light, another was on his knees in their midst, and I saw a book and an open knife in his hand. Soon the kneeling figure rose to his feet, and the whole party began to move towards the house. i saw a book and an open knife in his hand.

“Let ‘em come, lad,” said Silver, cheerily.

“I’ve still a shot in my locker.”

The door opened, and the five men, huddled together just inside, pushed one man forward.

“I won’t eat you, lad,” said Silver.

“Hand it over. I know the rules.”

The buccaneer passed something to Silver’s hand and slipped back to his companions.

“The black spot! I thought so,” observed the sea cook.

“Where might you have got the paper? Now, this ain’t lucky! What fool’s cut a Bible?”

“What did I say?” said Morgan.

“No good’ll come o’ that, I said.”

“Well, you’ve about fixed it now,” continued Silver.

“You’ll all swing now, I reckon.” But the man with the yellow eyes struck in.

“This crew has tipped you the black spot in full council, John Silver, as in duty bound. Just see what’s wrote there. Then you can talk.”

“Thanky, George,” replied the sea cook.

“You always was brisk for business, and has the rules by heart.

‘Deposed’ – that’s it, is it? Very pretty wrote, to be sure. Your hand, George? Why, you was getting to be quite a leading man in this here crew. You’ll be captain next. Just oblige me with that torch again. This pipe don’t draw.”

“You don’t fool this crew no more,” said George.

“You’re over now, and you’ll maybe step down off that barrel and help vote.”

“I thought you said you knowed the rules,” returned Silver, contemptuously.

“If you don’t, I do. I wait here – and I’m still your captain, mind – till you outs with your grievances, and I reply. In the meantime, your black spot ain’t worth a biscuit. After that, we’ll see.”

“Oh,” replied George, “don’t be under no appre-

hension. We’re all square, we are. First, you’ve made a hash of this cruise. Second, you let the enemy out o’ this here trap for nothing. Why did they want out? Third, you wouldn’t let us go at them upon the march. Oh, we see through you, John Silver. You want to play booty, that’s it. And, fourth, there’s this boy.”

“Is that all?” asked Silver, quietly.

“Enough, too,” retorted George.

“We’ll all hang in the sun for your bungling.”

“Well, now, look here, I’ll answer these four points. I made a hash of this cruise, did I? You all know what I wanted, and if that had been done, we’d ’a’ been aboard the Hispaniola this night, every man of us alive, and the treasure in the hold, by thunder! Who crossed me? Who tipped me the black spot the day we landed?

Why, it was Anderson, and Hands, and you, George Merry! You’re the last of that meddling crew, and you have the insolence to stand for cap’n over me – you, that sank the lot of us!”

Silver paused, and I could see by the faces of George and his late comrades that these words had not been said in vain.

“That’s for number one,” cried the accused.

“Why, you’ve neither sense nor memory, and I leave it to fancy where your mothers was that let you come to sea. Sea! Gentlemen o’ fortune! I reckon tailors is your trade.

“You say this cruise is bungled. By gum, if you could understand how bad it’s bungled, you would see!

We’re that near hanging that my neck’s stiff with thinking on it. And if you want to know about number four, and that boy, why, are we going to waste a hostage? No, not us. He might be our last chance. Kill that boy? Not me! And number three? Maybe you don’t count it to have a real college doctor come to see you every day – you, John, with your head broke – or you, George Merry, that had the shakes not six hours ago, and still has eyes the color of lemon peel?

“And maybe you didn’t know there was a rescue boat coming, either? But there is. And we’ll see who’ll be glad to have a hostage when it comes to that.

“And as for number two, and why I made a bar-

gain – well, you came crawling on your knees to me to make it, and you’d have starved, too, if I hadn’t – but that’s a trifle! You look there – that’s why!” And he cast down upon the floor none other than the chart on yellow paper, with the three red crosses, that I had found in the captain’s chest. Why the doctor had given it to him was more than I could fancy.

The appearance of the chart was incredible to the surviving mutineers. They leaped upon it like cats on a mouse. It went from hand to hand, one tearing it from another.

“Yes,” said one, “that’s Flint, sure enough. J.F., and a score below, with a clove hitch to it.”

“Mighty pretty,” said George.

“But how are we to get away with it, and us no ship?”

Silver sprang up, supporting himself with a hand against the wall: “I give you warning, George,” he cried.

“One more word of your sauce, and I’ll call you down. How? You ought to tell me that – you and the rest, that lost me my schooner! But not you, you can’t. You haven’t got the invention of a cockroach. You lost the ship; I found the treasure. Who’s the better man at that? I resign, by thunder! Elect whom you please to be your cap’n. I’m done with it!”

“Silver!” they cried.

“Barbecue forever! Barbecue for cap’n!”

“So that’s the tune, is it?” cried the cook.

“George,

I reckon you’ll have to wait another turn. Lucky for you I’m not a vengeful man. That never was my way. And now, shipmates, this black spot? ‘Tain’t much good now, is it? Dick’s crossed his luck and spoiled his Bible, and that’s about all.

“Here, Jim – here’s a curiosity for you,” said Silver,

and he tossed me the paper.

It was round. One side was blank, for it had been the last leaf. The other the Bible's New contained a verse or two of Revelation . contains a vision of These words struck home upon my mind: the world.

"Without are dogs and murderers." The printed side had been blackened with wood ash. On the blank side had been written with the same material the word "deposed." I still have that curiosity, but not a trace of writing now remains.

Soon after, with a drink all round, we lay down to sleep, and Silver's vengeance was to put George Merry up for sentinel, and threaten him with death if he should prove unfaithful.

It was long before I could sleep. Heaven knows I had matter enough for thought in the man whom I had slain that afternoon, in my own perilous position, and, above all, in the remarkable game that I saw Silver now engaged upon – keeping the mutineers together with one hand and grasping with the other after every means to save his miserable life. He himself slept peacefully and snored.

Yet my heart was sore for him, wicked as he was, to think on the dark perils that awaited him.

Chapter 30 - On Parole

Wewere wa kened by a clear, hearty voice hailing us from the margin of the "Blockhouse ahoy! Here's the doctor." I was glad to hear the sound, but my gladness was He must have risen in the dark, for the day had hardly come, and when I ran to a loophole and looked out, "Top o' the morning to you, Doctor!" cried Silver, beaming with good nature.

"George, help Dr. Livesey over the ship's side. All a-doin' well, your patients was – all well and merry.

"We've quite a surprise for you, too, sir," he continued.

"We've a stranger here – he! he! A new lodger, sir, slept alongside John all night."

"Not Jim?" The doctor stopped, and it was some seconds before he seemed able to move.

"Well, well," he said, at last, "duty first and pleasure afterwards, Silver. Let us overhaul these patients of yours."

He entered the blockhouse, and, with one grim nod to me, proceeded with his work. He seemed under no apprehension, though he must have known that his life among these demons depended on a hair.

"You're doing well, my friend," he said to the fellow with the bandaged head.

"And George, how goes it? Did he take that medicine, men? Because, since I am prison doctor, as I prefer to call it," says Dr. Livesey, "I make it a point of honor not to lose a

man for the gallows.”

The rogues swallowed the words in silence.

“Dick don’t feel well, sir,” said one.

“Well, step up here, Dick, and let me see your tongue,” said the doctor.

“No, I should be surprised if he did! Another fever.”

“That came of spoiling Bibles,” said Morgan.

“That came of being fools,” retorted the doctor, “and not having sense enough to know honest air from poison. You’ll all be sick before you get that malaria out of your systems. Camp in a bog, would you? Silver, you don’t appear to me to have a notion of the rules of health.

“Well,” he added, after they had taken his prescriptions, “that’s done for today. And now I want to have a talk with that boy, please.”

George Merry cried “No!” and swore.

Silver struck the barrel with his hand.

“Silence!” he roared.

“Doctor,” he went on, “I

was thinking of that, knowing how you had a fancy for the boy. Hawkins, will you give me your word of honor as a young gentleman not to escape?”

I readily gave the pledge required.

“Then, doctor,” said Silver, “you step outside o’ that stockade, and once you’re there, I’ll bring the boy down on the inside, and you can talk.”

The explosion of disapproval broke out immediately after the doctor had left the house. Silver was accused of playing double for his own gain. I could not imagine how he was to turn their anger, but he was twice the man the rest were. He called them fools and said it was necessary I should talk to the doctor, fluttered the chart in their faces, asked them if they could afford to break the treaty the very day they were bound a-treasure-hunting.

“No, by thunder!” he cried, “it’s us must break the treaty when the time comes.” And then he bade them get the fire lit, and stalked out, with his hand on my shoulder.

“Slow, lad,” he said.

“They might come upon us, if we was seen to hurry.” As soon as we were within easy speaking distance of the doctor, Silver stopped.

“The boy’ll tell you how I saved his life, doctor,” says he.

“You’ll please bear in mind it’s not my life only now – it’s the boy’s into the bargain, and you’ll speak fair, doctor, and give me a bit o’ hope to go on, for the sake of mercy.”

Silver was a changed man, once he had his back to his friends and the blockhouse.

His voice trembled, and never was a soul more in earnest.

“Why, John, you’re not afraid?” asked Dr. Livesey.

“Doctor, I’m no coward. But I’ve the shakes upon me for the gallows. You’re a good man, and you’ll not forget what I done good, not any more than you’ll forget the bad. I’ll step aside and leave you and Jim alone. And you’ll put that down for me, too!”

So saying, he stepped back out of earshot, and sat down upon a tree stump.

“So, Jim,” said the doctor, sadly, “I cannot find it in my heart to blame you, but this much I will say: when Captain Smollett was well, you dared not have gone off. When he was ill, and couldn’t help it, it was downright cowardly!”

I began to weep.

“Doctor,” I said, “I have blamed myself enough. And I should have been dead by now, if Silver hadn’t stood for me. I dare say I deserve to die – but what I fear is torture.”

“Jim, I can’t have this,” said the doctor.

“Jump, and we’ll run for it like antelopes.”

“jim,” said the doctor, “jump, and we’ll run for it like antelopes.”

“Doctor,” said I, “I gave my word. You wouldn’t do it yourself. Silver trusted me, and back I go. But if they torture me, I might let slip a word of where the ship is. She lies in North Inlet, on the southern beach, just below high water. At half-tide she must be high and dry.”

“The ship!” exclaimed the doctor. I described my adventures, and he heard me out in silence.

“Every step, it’s you that saves our lives. Do you suppose that we are going to let you lose yours? You found out the plot, you found Ben Gunn – the best deed that ever you did, or will do.”

“Silver, I’ll give you a piece of advice,” he continued, as the cook drew near.

“Don’t be in a great hurry after that treasure.”

“I can only save my life and the boy’s by seeking that treasure,” said Silver.

“Well, Silver,” replied the doctor, “if that is so, look out for squalls when you find it.”

“Sir,” said Silver, “that’s too much and too little. Why you left the blockhouse and given me the chart, I don’t know, and yet I done your bidding with my eyes shut and never a word of hope!”

“It’s not my secret, Silver, or I’d tell it to you. I’ll give you a bit of hope: If we both get out of this wolf trap, I’ll do my best to save you. That’s my first concession,” added the doctor.

“My second is advice: Keep the boy close beside you, and when you need help, halloo.

Goodbye, Jim.”

Dr. Livesey shook hands with me through the stockade, nodded to Silver, and set off.

Chapter 31 - Flint's Pointer

Jim,” said Silver, when we were alone, “if I saved your life, you saved mine, and I’ll not forget it. I seen the doctor waving you to run for it, and I seen you say no. Jim, that’s one to you. This is the first glint of hope I had since the attack failed and I owe it to you. Now, you and me must stick close, and we’ll save our necks in spite o’ fate and fortune.”

Just then a man hailed us that breakfast was ready, and we were soon seated about the sand over biscuit and fried pork. They had lit a fire fit to roast an ox. In the same wasteful spirit, they cooked three times more than we could eat, and one of them threw what was left into the fire. I never saw men so careless of the morrow. Hand to mouth is the only way to describe their way.

Even Silver, eating away, with Captain Flint upon his shoulder, had not a word of blame.

“Ay, mates,” said he, “it’s lucky you have Barbecue to think for you. Sure enough, they have the ship. Where they have it, I don’t know yet. But once we hit the treasure, we’ll have to find out. Then, mates, us that has the boats, I reckon, has the upper hand.” Thus he restored their hope and confidence.

“As for the hostage,” he continued, “I’ll take him in a line when we go treasure-hunting. We’ll keep him like so much gold, in case of accidents. Once we get the ship and treasure, and off to sea like jolly companions, why, then, we’ll give Mr. Hawkins his share, for his kindness.”

The men were in a good humor now. For my part, I was horribly cast down. Should the scheme he now sketched prove feasible, Silver, doubly a traitor, would not hesitate to adopt it. He had still a foot in i had a line about my waist, and followed obediently after either camp, and there was no doubt he would prefer wealth and freedom with the pirates to a bare escape from hanging. And even if he was forced to keep his faith with Dr. Livesey, what danger lay before us! When the suspicions of his followers turned to certainty, he and I should have to fight for dear life – against five strong seamen!

All but me were armed to the teeth. Silver had two guns slung about him – one before and one behind – besides the great cutlass at his wrist, and a pistol in each pocket of his square-tailed coat. Captain Flint sat perched upon his shoulder gabbling sea talk. I had a line about my waist, and followed obediently after the sea cook, led like a dancing bear.

Some men carried picks and shovels, and others were laden with pork, bread and brandy for the midday meal. Thus equipped, we all set out – even the fellow with the broken head – and straggled to the beach, where the two gigs awaited us. Both were to be carried along with us, for the sake of safety. So we set forth.

There was discussion on the chart. The red cross was far too large to be a guide, and the terms of the note were uncertain: Tall tree, Spyglass shoulder, bearing a point to the n. of

n.n.e. Skeleton Island e.s.e. and by e. Ten feet.

A tall tree was thus the principal mark. Before us, the anchorage was bounded by a plateau three hundred feet high that joined the sloping southern shoulder of the Spyglass. Here and there, a pine tree rose forty or fifty feet above its neighbors. Which of these was the particular "tall tree" could only be decided on the spot, and by the readings of the compass.

After quite a long passage, we landed at the mouth of the river that runs down a cleft of the Spyglass. Then, bending left, we began to ascend towards the plateau.

Miry ground and matted vegetation greatly delayed our progress. But little by little the hill began to steepen and become stony under foot, and the woods to grow in a more open order. The air was fresh and a wonderful refreshment to our senses.

The party spread in a fan shape, shouting and leaping. A good way behind the rest, Silver and I followed – I tethered by my rope, he ploughing, with deep pants, among the sliding gravel. From time to time, I had to lend him a hand, or he would have fallen backward down the hill.

We had thus proceeded for about half a mile, when a man gave a cry of terror. Shout after shout came from him, and the others began to run in his direction. We soon reached the spot. At the foot of a pine, partly covered by a vine, lay a human skeleton with a few shreds of clothing. I believe a chill struck every heart.

"He was a seaman," said George Merry, who had gone up close and was examining the rags of clothing.

"Leastwise, this is good sea cloth."

"Ay, ay," said Silver, "you wouldn't find a bishop here, I reckon. But what sort of a way is that for bones to be? It ain't in nature."

Indeed, the man lay perfectly straight – his feet pointing one direction, his hands, raised above his head like a diver's, pointing in the opposite.

"I've taken a notion into my old skull," said Silver.

"Here's the compass; there's the tip-top point o' Skeleton Island. Just take a bearing, will you, along the line of them bones."

It was done. The body pointed straight in the direction of the island, and the compass read duly e.s.e and by e.

"I thought so," cried the cook.

"This here is a pointer. This is one of Flint's jokes. Him and these six was alone here. He killed 'em, every man. And this one he hauled here and laid down by compass! They're long bones, and the hair's been yellow. Ay, that would be Allardyce. You remember Allardyce, Tom Morgan?"

"Ay, ay," returned Morgan.

"He owed me money, he did, and took my knife."

"Speaking of knives," said another, "why don't we find his lying around? Flint warn't

the man to pick a seaman's pocket."

"There ain't a thing left here," said Merry, still feeling round among the bones, "not even a tobacco box. It don't look natural to me."

"No, it don't," agreed Silver, "but, if Flint was living, this would be a hot spot for you and me. Six they were, and six we are, and bones is what they are now."

"I saw him dead," said Morgan.

"Sure enough he's dead and gone below," said the fellow with the bandage, "but if ever a spirit walked, it would be Flint's. He died bad!"

"Ay, he did," observed another.

"Now he raged, and now he hollered for rum, and now he sang. 'Fifteen Men' were his only song, mates, and I tell you true, I never rightly liked to hear it since."

"Come, come," said Silver, "stow this talk. He's dead, and he don't walk. Leastwise, he won't walk by day. Fetch ahead for doubloons." But the pirates no longer ran separate and shouting. They kept side by side. The terror of the dead buccaneer had fallen on their spirits.

Chapter 32 - The Voice Among the Trees

Partly from the influence of this alarm, partly to rest Silver and the sick folk, the whole party sat down as soon as they had gained the Before us, over the treetops, we beheld the Cape of the Woods fringed with surf. Behind, we looked down on the anchorage and Skeleton Island, and the open sea. Sheer above us rose the Spyglass. There was no sound but the distant breakers, and the chirp of countless insects. There was not a sail upon the sea. The very largeness of the view increased the sense of solitude.

Silver took bearings with his compass.

"There are three tall trees," said he, "about in the right line from Skeleton Island. It's child's play to find the stuff now. I've half a mind to dine first."

"I don't feel sharp," growled Morgan.

"Thinkin' o' Flint – I think it were – 'as done me."

"Praise your stars he's dead," said Silver.

"He were an ugly devil," cried a third pirate, with a shudder.

"Blue in the face, too."

"That was how the rum took him," added Merry.

"Blue! Well, I reckon he was blue."

Ever since they had found the skeleton, they had spoken lower and lower, and they had almost got to whispering. All of a sudden, out of the trees in front of us, a thin, high,

trembling voice struck up the well-known air and words: I never have seen men more dreadfully affected. The color went from their six faces. Some leaped to their feet, some clawed hold of others. Morgan grovelled on the ground.

“It’s Flint!” cried Merry.

The song stopped suddenly – broken off, in the middle of a note, as though someone had laid his hand upon the singer’s mouth.

“Come,” said Silver, struggling to get the word out.

“This is someone playing a joke.”

His courage and color came back as he spoke. The others were coming a little to themselves, when the same voice broke out again – not singing, but in a faint distant hail, that echoed yet fainter among the clefts of the Spyglass.

“Darby M’Graw,” it wailed.

“Darby M’Graw!” again and again and again. Then rising a little higher, and with an oath, “Fetch aft the rum, Darby!”

The buccaneers’ eyes bulged in their heads. Long after the voice had died away they stared in silence before them.

“That fixes it!” gasped one.

“Let’s go!”

“They was his last words,” moaned Morgan.

Dick had his Bible out and was praying.

Still, Silver was unconquered. I could hear his “darby m’graw,” it wailed.

“darby m’graw!” teeth rattle in his head, but he had not yet surrendered.

“Shipmates,” he cried, “I’m here to get that stuff, and I’ll not be beat by man nor devil. I never was feared of Flint in his life, and I’ll face him dead. There’s seven hundred thousand pound not a quarter of a mile from here.

When did ever a gentleman of fortune show his stern to that much dollars, for a drunken old seaman with a blue face – and him dead, too?”

“Stop, John!” said Merry.

“Don’t you cross a spirit.” And the rest were all too terrified to reply. They would have run away had they dared, but fear kept them together.

“Spirit? Well, maybe,” he said.

“But there’s one thing not clear to me. There was an echo. No man ever seen a spirit with a shadow. Well, what’s he doing with an echo to him, I should like to know? That ain’t in nature, surely?”

This argument seemed weak to me. But you can never tell what will affect the superstitious, and, to my wonder, George Merry was relieved.

“Well, that’s so,” he said.

“‘Bout ship, mates! This here crew is on a wrong tack, I do believe. And come to think on it, it was like somebody else’s voice now – it was like – ” “Ben Gunn!” roared Silver.

“It don’t make much difference, do it?” asked Dick.

“Ben Gunn’s not here, any more’n Flint.” But the older hands greeted this with scorn.

“Why, nobody minds Ben Gunn,” cried Merry.

“Dead or alive, nobody minds him.”

It was extraordinary how their spirits had returned. Soon they shouldered the tools and set forth again, Merry walking first with Silver’s compass to keep them on the right line with Skeleton Island.

Dick still held his Bible, and looked behind him as he went, with fearful glances.

“I told you,” said Silver, “you had spoiled your Bible. If it ain’t no good to swear by, what do you suppose a spirit would give for it? Not that!” and he snapped his big fingers.

Indeed, Dick was falling sick. Hastened by heat, exhaustion, and fear, the fever, predicted by Dr. Livesey, was growing swiftly higher.

The first of the tall trees was reached, and by the bearing, proved the wrong one. So with the second. The third rose nearly two hundred feet into the air above a clump of underwood, but it was not its size that impressed my companions. It was the knowledge that gold lay somewhere buried below its spreading shadow. The thought of the money swallowed up their previous terrors. Their feet grew speedier and lighter. Each of their souls was bound up in that fortune, that lifetime of extravagance and pleasure, that lay waiting there for each of them.

Silver hobbled, grunting, on his crutch. He plucked furiously at the line that held me to him, and turned his eyes upon me with a deadly look. He took no pains to hide his thoughts. In the nearness of the gold, all had been forgotten. His promise and the doctor’s warning were both things of the past. I did not doubt that he hoped to seize the treasure, board the Hispaniola, cut every honest throat on the island, and sail away laden with crimes and riches.

Shaken as I was, it was hard to keep up with the rapid pace of the treasure-hunters. Now and again I stumbled, and it was then that Silver plucked so roughly at the rope, and launched at me his murderous glances. Dick, who had dropped behind us, was babbling to himself both prayers and curses, as his fever kept rising.

We were now at the margin of the thicket, and the foremost broke into a run.

Suddenly, ten yards further, we saw them stop. A low cry arose. Silver doubled his pace, digging away with his crutch like one possessed. And the next moment we also came to a halt.

Before us was a great excavation, not very recent, for the sides had fallen in and grass had sprouted. In it were the shaft of a pick broken in two and boards strewn around. On one board I saw the name Walrus – Flint’s ship.

The cache had been found and rifled. The seven hundred thousand pounds were gone!

Chapter 33 - The Fall of a Chieftain

Each of these six men seemed struck by a blow. But with Silver the blow passed almost instantly. His every thought had been set, like a racer, on that money. Now he was brought up dead, and he kept his head and changed his plan before the others had time to realize “Jim,” he whispered, “stand by for trouble.” And he passed me a double-barrelled pistol. At the same time, in a few steps, he had put the hollow between us two and the other five. Then he looked at me and nodded quite friendly. I was so revolted at these constant changes that I could not resist whispering, “So you’ve changed sides again.”

There was no time left for him to answer. The buccaneers, with oaths, began to leap into the pit and dig with their fingers. Morgan found a piece of gold and held it up.

“Two guineas!” roared Merry, shaking it at Silver.

“That’s your seven hundred thousand pounds, is it? You’re the man for bargains, ain’t you. You woodenheaded lubber!”

There we stood, two on one side, five on the other, the pit between us, and nobody ready to offer the first blow. Silver never moved. He watched them, very upright on his crutch, and looked as cool as ever I saw him. He was brave.

“Mates,” says Merry, at last, “there’s two of them. One’s the old cripple that brought us here and blundered us down to this, the other’s the cub that I mean to have the heart of. Now, mates – ”

He was raising his arm and plainly meant to lead a charge. Then – crack! crack! crack! – three musket shots flashed out of the thicket. Merry tumbled head-first into the excavation. The man with the bandage spun like a top and fell dead, but still twitching, and the other three turned and ran for it with all their might.

Before you could wink, Long John had fired two barrels into the struggling Merry. As the man rolled up his eyes at him in the last agony, “George,” said Silver, “I reckon I settled you.”

At the same moment the doctor, Gray, and Ben Gunn joined us, with smoking muskets, from among the nutmeg trees.

“Forward!” cried the doctor.

“Double quick, my lads. We must head ‘em off the boats.” And we set off at a great pace. The work Silver went through, leaping on his crutch till the muscles of his chest were fit to burst, was work no man ever equalled, so said the doctor.

“Doctor,” he hailed, “see there! No hurry!”

Sure enough, in a more open part of the plateau, we could see the three survivors still running in the same direction as they had started. We were already between them and the

boats. We four sat down to breathe, while Long John, mopping his face, came slowly up with us.

“Thank ye kindly, doctor,” says he.

“You came in the nick of time, I guess, for me and Hawkins. And so it’s you, Ben Gunn!” he added.

“I’m Ben Gunn, I am,” replied the maroon, wriggling like an eel in his embarrassment.

“And,” he added, “how do, Mr. Silver?”

“Ben, Ben,” murmured Silver, “to think as you’ve done me!”

The doctor sent Gray for a pickaxe left by the mutineers, and then as we proceeded down to the boats, related what had taken place. It was a story that profoundly interested Silver, and Ben Gunn, the maroon, was the hero.

Ben, in his lonely wanderings about the island, had found the skeleton. It was he that stole from it. He had found the treasure, and he had dug it up. He had carried it on his back, in many weary journeys, from the foot of the tall pine to a cave where it had lain stored in safety since before the arrival of the Hispaniola.

The doctor had wormed this secret from Ben on the day of the attack. The next morning, when he saw the anchorage deserted, he had gone to Silver, given him the chart, which was now useless, and the stores, for Ben Gunn’s cave was well supplied with salted goats’ meat – given everything to get a chance of moving in safety from the stockade to the two-pointed hill, to be clear of malaria and keep a guard on the money.

“As for you, Jim,” he said, “I did what I could for those who had stood by their duty. If you were not one of these, whose fault was it?” That morning, finding that I was to be involved in the horrid disappointment he had prepared for the mutineers, he had run to the cave, and leaving the squire to guard the captain, had taken Gray and the maroon, and started across the island to be at hand beside the pine. When he saw that our party was ahead of him, Ben Gunn was dispatched alone to work upon the superstitions of his former shipmates. He was so successful that Gray and the doctor were in ambush before the arrival of the treasure hunters.

“Ah,” said Silver, “it were fortunate that I had Hawkins here. You would have let old John be cut to bits, and never given it a thought.”

“Not a thought,” replied Dr. Livesey.

By this time, we reached the gigs. The doctor, with a pickaxe, demolished one, and then we all got aboard the other, and set out for North Inlet.

This was a run of eight or nine miles. Silver, though he was almost killed already with fatigue, set to an oar, like the rest of us, and we were soon skimming swiftly over a smooth sea. As we passed the two-pointed hill, we could see the black mouth of Ben Gunn’s cave, and the squire standing by it, leaning on a musket. We waved a handkerchief and gave him three cheers, in which Silver joined as heartily as any.

Just inside the mouth of North Inlet, we met the Hispaniola cruising by herself. The last flood had lifted her, and had there been much wind, or a strong tide, we should never have found her, or found her stranded beyond help. As it was, there was little amiss. Another anchor was got ready and dropped in a fathom of water.

We all pulled round again to Rum Cove, the A measurehouse. Then Gray returned with the gig to ment of six feet.

At the entrance of the cave, the squire met us. To me he was cordial, saying nothing of my escapade. At Silver's salute he changed color.

"John Silver," he said, "you're a villain. I am told not to prosecute you. Well, then, I will not. But the dead men, sir, hang about your neck."

"Thank you kindly, sir," replied Long John.

"I dare you to thank me!" cried the squire.

"It is a gross neglect of my duty. Stand back." And then we entered the cave. It was a large, airy place, with a little spring and a pool of clear water overhung with ferns. The floor was sand. Before a big fire lay

Captain Smollett, and in a far corner, in the flickering light, I beheld heaps of coin and stacks of gold bars. That was Flint's treasure that we had come so far to seek, and that had cost already the lives of seventeen men. How many it had cost in the amassing, what blood and sorrow, what good ships scuttled, what shame and lies and cruelty, perhaps no man alive could tell. Yet there were still three upon that island – Silver, Morgan, and Ben Gunn – who had each a share in these crimes, as each had hoped in vain to share in the reward.

"Come in, Jim," said the captain.

"You're a good boy, in your line, Jim. But I don't think you and me will go to sea again. Is that you, John Silver? What brings you here?"

"Come back to do my duty, sir."

"Ah!" was all the captain said.

What a supper I had that night, with all my friends around me. And what a meal it was, with Ben Gunn's salted goat, some delicacies, and a bottle of old wine from the Hispaniola. Never, I am sure, were people happier. Silver sat back almost out of the firelight, eating heartily, even joining quietly in our laughter – the same polite, obsequious seaman of the voyage out.

Chapter 34 - And Last

The next morning we fell to work early, for the transportation of this great mass of gold near a mile by land to the beach, and then three miles by boat to the Hispaniola, was a considerable task for us. The three fellows still abroad upon the island did not trouble us.

Therefore the work pushed on briskly. Gray and Ben Gunn came and went with the boat, while the rest piled treasure on the beach. Two of the bars, slung in a rope, made a good load for a grown man. I was busy all day in the cave, packing money into bread bags.

It was a strange collection of coins. Doubloons, double guineas, moidores, and sequins, the pictures of all the kings of Europe for the last hundred years, strange Oriental pieces stamped with what looked like bits of spider's web, round pieces and square pieces, and pieces bored through the middle, as if to wear them around your neck – nearly every variety of money in the world, I think.

Day after day this work went on, and all this time we heard nothing of the three mutineers.

At last – I think it was on the third night – the doctor and I were strolling on the shoulder of the hill where it overlooks the lowlands of the isle, when, from out of the darkness below, the wind brought us a noise between shrieking and singing.

“Heaven forgive them,” said the doctor.

“All drunk, sir,” added Silver.

Silver, I should say, was allowed his liberty, and, in spite of daily rebuffs, seemed to regard himself once more as a privileged dependent. Indeed, it was remarkable how well he bore these slights, and with what unwearying politeness he kept trying to ingratiate himself. Yet, none treated him better than a dog, unless it doubloons, double guineas, moidores, and sequins — it was a strange collection of coins. was Ben Gunn, who was still afraid of his old quartermaster, or me, who really had something to thank him for. Although, I suppose, I had reason to think even worse of him than anybody else, for I had seen him meditating a fresh treachery on the plateau. That was about the last news we had of the three pirates. Once we heard a gunshot a way off, and supposed them to be hunting. A council was held, and it was decided that we must desert them on the island – to the glee of Ben

Gunn. We left them a good stock of powder and shot, the bulk of the salt goat, a few medicines, and some other necessities, tools, clothing, a spare sail, a fathom or two of rope, and, by the desire of the doctor, a handsome present of tobacco.

At last, one fine morning, we weighed anchor and stood out of North Inlet, the same colors flying that the captain had flown and fought under at the palisade.

Coming through the narrows, we saw all three mutineers kneeling together on a spit of sand, with their arms raised. It went to all our hearts, I think, to leave them in that wretched state, but we could not risk another mutiny, and to take them home for the gallows would have been a cruel sort of kindness. The doctor hailed them and told them where to find the stores we had left. But they continued to call us by name and appealed to us not leave them to die.

At last, seeing the ship still bore her course, one of them leapt to his feet with a hoarse cry, whipped his musket to his shoulder, and sent a shot whistling over Silver's head.

After that, we kept under cover of the bulwarks, and when next I looked out they had disappeared from the spit, and the spit itself had almost melted out of sight. That was the end of that, and before noon, to my joy, the highest rock of Treasure Island had sunk into the sea.

We were so short of men that everyone had to bear a hand – only the captain lying on a mattress in the stern and giving his orders. We laid her head for the nearest port in Spanish America, for we could not risk the voyage home without fresh hands. As it was, we were

worn out before we reached it.

It was sundown when we cast anchor in a most beautiful landlocked gulf. We were immediately surrounded by boats full of native people selling fruits and vegetables and offering to dive for bits of money. The sight of so many good humored faces, the taste of tropical fruits, and, above all, the lights that began to shine in the town, made a charming contrast to our dark and bloody sojourn on the island. The doctor and the squire, taking me along, went ashore, where they met the captain of an English man-owar and boarded his ship.

Day was breaking when we came back alongside the Hispaniola . Ben Gunn was on deck alone, and as soon as we came on board, he made a confession. Silver was gone. Ben Gunn had aided his escape in a shore boat some hours ago, and he now assured us he had done so to preserve our lives. But this was not all. The seacook had taken one of the sacks of coin, worth perhaps three or four hundred guineas. I think we were all pleased to be so cheaply quit of him.

Well, to make a long story short, we got a few hands on board, made a good cruise home, and reached Bristol just as Mr. Blandly was beginning to think of sending the rescue boat.

All of us had an ample share of the treasure and used it wisely or foolishly, according to our natures. Captain Smollett retired from the sea. Gray studied his profession, and he is now mate and part owner of a fine, fullrigged ship. He is married besides, and the father of a family. As for Ben Gunn, he got a thousand pounds, which he spent or lost in nineteen days, for he was back begging on the twentieth. Then he was given a lodge to keep. He is a great favorite, though, and is a notable singer in church on Sundays and saints' days.

Of Silver we have heard no more. That formidable man with one leg has at last gone clean out of my life. I dare say he met his wife and perhaps still lives in comfort with her and Captain Flint. It is to be hoped so, for his chances of comfort in another world are very small.

The bar silver and the arms still lie, for all that I know, where Flint buried them. Nothing could bring me back again to that accursed island. The worst dreams I ever have are when I hear the surf booming about its coasts, or when I start upright in bed, with the voice of Captain Flint ringing in my ears: "Pieces of eight! Pieces of eight!" corbis-bettman

Robert Louis Stevenson

1850 - 1894 Robert Louis Stevenson was born in Edinburgh, Scotland, the son of an engineer who built lighthouses. He was an only child and passed many days sick in bed, making up stories with his nurse, to whom he dedicated his famous book of poetry, *A Child's Garden of Verses* . All his life he was skinny and prone to illness, usually in his lungs. As an adult he wandered over half the world in search of a place that favored his health.

He studied at the University of Edinburgh, first to be an engineer, and then a lawyer. But he turned instead to writing essays, plays and stories. For a while, he took up the pose of a rebellious artist, wearing long hair, floppy hats and velvet jackets, and convinced his parents that he had become a vagabond.

While hanging out at an artists' colony near Paris, he met Fanny Osborne, an American ten years older than himself. Fanny had left her husband in California and was grieving over the death of her youngest son. Stevenson was crushed when she decided to return to San Francisco, and when she wrote to tell him that she was ill, he immediately went to her. But by the time he arrived in California he was very sick and she instead took care of him.

Fanny divorced her husband and married Stevenson in 1880. They honeymooned at an abandoned silver mine and then went back to England. From there they went to health resorts in Switzerland and the south of France.

In 1888, they sailed for Polynesia, in the warm South Pacific, hoping the tropics would be good for Stevenson's health. For a year-and-a-half they roamed the scattered islands. Stevenson even visited a leper colony in Hawaii. Finally they settled on one of the islands in Samoa, where they built a plantation house they named Vailima.

The Samoans called Stevenson Tustitala , or "storyteller." He sided with them against the colonial schemes of Europeans, and the Samoans, in thanks, built a road to his house that they named the Road of the Loving Heart.

Wherever he went, Stevenson was liked for his graceful, charming ways and his sincerity.

Though his health was better, the cares of his household were heavy. Fanny had a nervous breakdown in 1893. The next year, Stevenson, frail and alive mainly out of determination, died of a burst blood vessel in his brain.

In his own time, his wandering life itself seemed a romantic adventure. He wrote *Treasure Island* in 1883 and it made him very popular. His other famous stories include *The Strange Case of Dr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde* and *Kidnapped*.

When young Jim Hawkins finds a treasure map, he stumbles into a thrilling adventure with cutthroat buccaneers. The pirate Long John Silver—devious, greedy and charming—at first befriends Jim but then takes him hostage. *Treasure Island* remains both a captivating coming-of-age story and the pattern for popular

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